FADE IN:

…on BLACK.

We hear...

…the SCAMPER of FOOTSTEPS SHUFFLE through LEAVES.

…HEAVY BREATHING.

…POLICE SIRENS GROW LOUDER and LOUDER.

DISSOLVE TO:

EXT. APARTMENT COMPLEX - EVENING

FLASH ON EL, a young mute Seminole girl crouched in the bushes; alert next to her stands ALBIE, a companion and a dog.

SIRENS blare, the sound is overwhelming. The LIGHTS from the SIRENS beat against EL and ALBIE's faces.

They both watch in horror as the police try and break into an apartment on the second floor across and above from where they hide.

CUT TO:

INT. YELLOW CORVETTE TRUNK - EVENING

SHEEN, a naked young adult Latina, lies slack jawed in the trunk of a YELLOW CORVETTE covered in blood, her neck black and bruised; she's tied up hog style and most importantly, she's dead.

PULL BACK to REVEAL:

The SHADOW of a MAN in head to toe BIKER GEAR looms over the trunk, his hand on the hood.

FLASH CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / BATHROOM - EVENING

SHEEN, same one as before, lies slack jawed on the toilet, arms sliced not sideways for attention but longways for results.

CLOSE ON a NAIL POLISHED HAND WRITING a SUICIDE NOTE with SHEEN's DEAD and HEAVY ARM.

FLASH CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / BEDROOM - EVENING

SHEEN, slumped over her bed, nose and mouth bloodied; her hands clutch her face, a foaming drink fizzles spilt on the carpet.

SHEEN twitches and contorts.

SHEEN's breath runs out and she dies.

The SHADOW of a NAKED MAN lingers in the background.

FLASH CUT TO:

EXT. APARTMENT COMPLEX - EVENING

Fear grips EL, EL grips ALBIE; their bodies now closer together then just moments before.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT - MORNING

FLASH ON EL, sitting on the couch across from her adopted parents, SANDRA and DAVE, sitting on different chairs, hands clasped.

They take a collective deep breath before we—

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / EL'S BEDROOM - MORNING

EL's alarm fires off at 6:00am, snoozed by a disembodied hand, then blares once more at 6:07am.

EL propels herself out of bed after a grimace and some hesitance. She knows if it's not going to be now it's going to be never.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / BATHROOM - MORNING

EL's in the bathroom, brushing her teeth, and taking care of other morning routines a preteen might embark upon.

EL checks her pretty popular blog, reviews new notifications (and responds to a few), she writes a good morning post.

EL reviews MIA's blog. MIA is a bully from EL's high school, and posts a ton of selfies and gets a lot of comments from boys much to EL's chagrin.

SANDRA knocks on the bathroom door, her hair up on her head in a towel, EL unlocks the door and SANDRA pops her head in.

EL hands her a brush.

DAVE (O.S.)
Look, we know it's been a tough year for you, sweetie.

SANDRA (O.S.)
A very, very tough year, dear.

DAVE (O.S.)
And we're also pretty sure you know that it's been a tough year for us too. Like super hard. Lots of unforeseen bumps in the road. Some even closer calls.

SANDRA (O.S.)
Dave got fired—

DAVE (O.S.)
—Dave, got let go.

SANDRA (O.S.)
Dave got let go.

DAVE (O.S.)
I'm getting unemployment. It is different and worth noting.

SANDRA (O.S.)
Yes, of course, I know that. I don't see why its important for the sake of this conversation though.

DAVE (O.S.)
They're very different things. One implies that I was not a good worker, and the other implies the company has fallen on hard times.

SANDRA (O.S.)
Dear, pedantic is when someone is annoying about minor details of a story, details that don't really change the fact of the matter.

DAVE (O.S.)
She knows what pedantic means. She is 14. There's also a difference between being annoying about a detail and being concerned with conveying the whole truth.

SANDRA (O.S.)
I was talking to you, Dave. El, point is: money is a bit tight around here at the moment.

DAVE (O.S.)
We are not poor.

SANDRA (O.S.)
Not poor, or broke, or in danger of getting kicked out or anything of that sort of serious nature. We're letting you know because we want to treat you like an adult.

DAVE (O.S.)
Its just that money is going to be tight until I find work again.

SANDRA (O.S.)
This is not why we sat you down to talk.

DAVE (O.S.)
Yeah, yeah. The point is—

SANDRA (O.S.)
The point is we are gonna need some help around here.

DAVE (O.S.)
Nothing back breaking, or anything of the sort.

SANDRA (O.S.)
No, of course not. Just a little help here and little help there. You really are already carrying a lot of your own weight. We just need a little extra help.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / HALLWAY - MORNING

EL and DAVE have an awkward encounter in the hallway, with low lighting. One tries to pass by moving to the right, the other also tries to move right—then both to the left, and so on and so on.

DAVE (O.S.)
Nothing we wouldn't ask of our own daughter. Which is what we consider you, sweetie. One of us. And when a family is hurting, we need to watch out for each other.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / EL'S BEDROOM - MORNING

In EL's room, there is a canvas with oil painting she left up from the night before, it is dark, muddy, grey.

EL gives it a look over before dipping a new brush into paint, she adds one stroke.

Then snaps a picture of it with her cellphone.

SANDRA (O.S.)
You are like our own daughter, of course, of course! Its just that going school shopping every few months for new clothes, the daily bus fare, the money everyday for school lunch. Its just that its getting a little too tight to squeeze. And also, we think working is a very, very important character building activity. Very important!

DAVE (O.S.)
My grandpa used to make my dad dig holes in the backyard. Told him that blisters were the sign of a man. I had a job since I was ten helping my dad empty septic tanks back up north in Jersey. We're not asking for you to empty septic tanks, no siree—wouldn't wish that job on my worst enemy—also Florida doesn't have septic tanks, I don't think

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / KITCHEN - MORNING

EL pops two waffles into the toaster.

EL washes the newly dirtied brush.

Pulls up the photo of her painting on Photoshop, and starts editing it at the kitchen table, waiting for the toaster.

DAVE joins her at the kitchen table with a bowl of cereal.

SANDRA (O.S.)
And I worked for my daddy too, helping him type up his psych notes at the end of the day and file them by color coding them. My mom actually trained me to type at six years old. The main idea here is that we need some help around here.

DAVE (O.S.)
We made a list of some potential jobs that a 14 year old girl with your temperament might be able to handle. Just a few quick ideas to throw your way.

SANDRA (O.S.)
Yes, a few things we think might suit you nicely and not stress your poor self too hard with. Like I said, just some things for some pocket change so you can treat yourself when you want that extra scoop of ice cream. Buy some candy on the way home from school, or get two cookies. This extra help is just for you. Just for you to take care of yourself. We will never ask for a dime.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / EL'S BEDROOM - MORNING

EL rushes to grab a pair of shoes.

EL then memorialize a picture of her mother she pulls out from her bedside table drawer.

EL moves over to her window, brushing her hair, and peaks out trough the blinds. Her bedroom overlooks the parking lot, and she spies GARY, late 30's - early 40's, talking to a handful of his illegal migrant workers. After some deliberating, a few get into his pickup, a few get into their own beat up car, and both vehicles take off.

Almost at the same moment, a YELLOW CORVETTE with a loud rumbling exhaust pulls into the parking lot, SHEEN gets out of the car and heads up a flight of stairs, the YELLOW CORVETTE pulls out of the lot.

DAVE (O.S.)
We all need to learn how to take care of ourselves, anyway.

SANDRA (O.S.)
Its the most important lesson anyone could learn.

DAVE (O.S.)
So best to learn it early!

SANDRA (O.S.)
Dave, do you have the list?

DAVE (O.S.)
Right here. Wait.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / LIVING ROOM - MORNING

CAMERA FRAMES EL, SANDRA, and DAVE.

CAMERA SUPER SLOW ZOOM onto EL's FACE until we reach an EXTREME CLOSEUP.

DAVE reaches into his pockets to dig out the note, it takes him a minute, and a few tries, but he successfully finds the list, looks at it for a moment about to read it, and then hands it to SANDRA.

SANDRA
Okay, so this one is a cool one. A playmate slash babysitter.

DAVE
Or! We were thinking maybe bagging groceries at Publix. And there's a Publix between your school and o apartment. And I bet you'll not only make an hourly wage, but if you help some of the old folks out of the door and into their car

they might hand you an extra buck or two. Perfect, right?

SANDRA
Oh, here's a great one, especially because you are so super smart. A math tutor for some public school kids? You've always been really strong at math, that is for sure.

DAVE
And I've never been good in math, not my whole life, and boy, would've I killed for a sweet, cute tutor like yourself when I was a young kid. Not that I'm too old now.

EL's lack of reaction to their suggestions causes SANDRA and DAVE to panic.

SANDRA reviews the entirety of the list, stammers, and then says:

SANDRA
Um, a lot of our neighbors have pets, maybe a dog walker?

EL's face lights up at this suggestion. She nods her head, and her step parents are relieved.

EL reaches into her pocket and pulls out a deck of cards wrapped in a rubber band.

CLOSE ON EL thumbing through the cards. The cards, on one side, appear as normal playing cards, on the other side, are hand written phrases in marker.

EL hands DAVE one of the cards, and before looking at what the card says, he then hands the card right to SANDRA.

CLOSE ON SANDRA'S HAND HOLDING the CARD in the foreground over EL's face in the background.

TEXT: "Sounds Good!"

SANDRA's HAND pulls out of frame, and EL's smiling face comes into focus.

CUT TO:

EXT. HIGH SCHOOL / COURTYARD - AFTERNOON

All around high school teens are engaged in their lunch period: selfie slash video taking, instant messaging, and other forms of electronic distractions. This is high school, kids are smoking cigarettes, boys and girls flirt. Boys are playing handball, some of the kids are shirtless with their tee tucked into their back pocket.

The CAMERA lingers on the children for awhile, before PULLING BACK to reveal:

EL, distant from the others, sits on a bench near the opposite end of the playground where the chaos of recess unfolds, she is munching on a snack, laptop in her lap, and earbuds in her ears.

CLOSE ON her laptop: she builds a flyer offering her dog walking services.

The screen of her laptop switches between her working on the flyer, to her skipping/muting some ads on Youtube, to her writing an ad on Craigslist and a local dog walkers blog.

A message pings on her screen.

CUT TO a group of girls in the distance crowded around one particular girl's phone. They are laughing.

CLOSE on MIA amongst the group of girls, her the ringleader.

EL opens the message on her computer and it is from the group of girls, they are taunting her. It is a message presented as faux friendliness, but EL's reaction to their message makes it clear that this is anything but friendly.

EL's disgusted as another barrage of messages proceed to unfurl, and she quickly ignores the messages.

CUT TO:

EXT. MILITARY BASE - AFTERNOON

A group of live and tied female bodies are lined up against a cement wall, their heads concealed by burlap sacks, the sacks tied around their throats with yarn tied into exaggerated red bows like a giant Christmas present.

CAMERA PULLS BACK to REVEAL EL in boots and military garb, her arm cocked behind her back gripping a pistol.

EL pacing to and fro pivots on her heels, pauses center aligned in the FRAME, pulls the pistol from behind her back, takes a moment to aim and fires.

The girls on the wall scream upon hearing the first round sound off.

EL unloads the entire clip of the pistol into their bodies.

CLOSE ON the girls as they die in slow motion.

EL lifts the smoking barrel to her lip and blows like a real cowgirl.

CUT TO:

EXT. HIGH SCHOOL / COURTYARD - AFTERNOON

She continues to multitask her projects before once again being pinged by the girls—this time, however, its a picture of her from the girls perspective, and they are taunting her even further.

EL closes her laptop, wraps up her earbuds, and packs up her belongings into her backpack.

In the distance the group of girls draw near.

EL, in no rush, walks off, leaving the school grounds, and heads down the sidewalk.

CUT TO:

EXT. STREET - AFTERNOON

EL meanders down the street of her neighborhood.

She window shops, snapping photos of some things she may want in the future.

EL adds to her list of ‘Future Endeavors’ the hopes of owning her own pair of faux leather pants and maybe a fur coat when she moves away from Florida.

CUT TO:

EXT. BAKERY - AFTERNOON

EL stops at the local bakery and lingers outside of the entrance.

There is a customer inside, wrapping up her order, so EL hangs back and allows for the customer to finish her order before she proceeds inside.

We can hear the conversation between the BAKER and CUSTOMER.

CUSTOMER
Okay, you convinced me. One pound of chocolate covered strawberries.

BAKER
You're not going to regret it. I promise.

CUSTOMER
Yeah, well, if my husband asks, you pulled my arm.

BAKER
If your husband tries these strawberries he ain't gonna be asking who pulled which arm to deliver them to his belly.

CUSTOMER
His big belly. And from your mouth to God's ears.

BAKER
And dear, do His ear's hear.

CUSTOMER
Me and Harry drove by this church off Hypoluxo on the way to chemo the other day. It has those beautiful bells swinging from the steeple up above, you ever see them?

BAKER
Yes, they don't work—

CUSTOMER
But they sure look nice!

BAKER
God bless you!

CUSTOMER
And you as well, dear. Have a happy holiday. See you soon.

The CUSTOMER heads out of the shop and walks past EL.

CUT TO:

INT. BAKERY - AFTERNOON

Once the CUSTOMER leaves the bakery, EL enters the bakery, behind the counter is SHARON. SHARON is a single, middle aged woman, religious, and an avid plant collector.

SHARON
El! Perfect timing! You just missed a whole heck of a crowd. Bingo let out down the block, and all the ladies walked on down here for “their exercise” and ate a load of cannoli. One of them had one vanilla gingerbread man and one chocolate gingerbread man—the whole crew gave her hell for it. Those old birds!

EL walks up to the counter, and SHARON hands her a prepackaged box of baked goods.

EL opens the ribbon surrounding the box, takes out a baked good and munches on it.

SHARON (CONTD.)
I didn’t tie the ribbon tight this time. I packed some rainbow cookies for Sandra. Send your mom my regards.

EL waves behind a munching mouth and begins to leave the bakery. She takes a step towards the door between each munch and each word that SHARON offers.

SHARON (CONTD.)
Also, mass this Sunday morning, like every Sunday, if you’d like. The Father keeps asking about you. He says, where is that sweet young girl you used to bring all the time. El, I promise you, he will change your life. It’s important to have an ear of the man who has the ear of God. And never let the Devil grab hold of you!

CUT TO:

INT. CHURCH - MORNING

SHARON kneels at the altar dressed in robes, light pours through the stained glass. She speaks in tongues, body contorting.

A priest stands before her, consecrating her.

CUT TO:

INT. BAKERY - AFTERNOON

EL, laughs, then waves once again, this time more certainly and affirmatively, before slipping out the front door, giggling further.

CUT TO:

EXT. STREET - AFTERNOON

SHEEN passes by EL walking down the street.

EL sneaks a glance up at SHEEN, looking worse for wear.

EL waits for a few seconds, then turns and watches SHEEN walk, and falter in her heels, before entering into the bakery.

CUT TO:

INT. PUBLIC TRANSPORTATION / BUS - AFTERNOON

EL works again on her computer, the chaos of the bus surrounds her, and she is able to ignore it. She plays around with fonts and sizes of shapes on her flyer.

She makes a short list of places to post the flyers around.

Listening to music, and visibly flustered, she closes her laptop, places it into her backpack, and takes out a notepad before staring out the bus window, watching traffic and taking in the ambiance of the environment.

EL scans the bus, then begins to sketch one of the people on the bus. She draws a quick, and rough outline, before layering on detail. She is talented.

The bus halts to a stop.

EL watches those who get on the bus, she notices HUGH walk onto the bus. HUGH is one of EL's neighbors; he is in his 70's, retired, Jewish, and from New York. His hands are filled with plastic grocery bags from PUBLIX and he struggles to find the change in his pocket to pay for the bus fare.

After it takes too long, and after HUGH assures the bus driver he has all the money and just needs to dig for it, the driver puts the bus back in motion, making HUGH wobble and almost lose balance before regaining control and continuing the change hunt.

HUGH finishes paying his fare, and walks to find a seat. He finds one, sits in it, adjusts himself, before making eye contact with EL, eye contact that she tries to evade, but once the eye contact is made there is no turning back.

HUGH beckons EL over to a seat near him with a big smile.

HUGH
El! El! Come sit down over here, come give me a hand.

EL gets up with only minor hesitation and makes her way to sitting next to HUGH on the bus. Her posture defeated: shoulders slumped.

EL plops down right next to HUGH after he moves some of his grocery bags. They are sitting next to one another, and as HUGH begins to rant, no eye contact is made.

HUGH
Barbra, keeps telling me to get more exercise, to at least go for a walk around the block—she keeps saying how Publix is just around the corner and that my body could use the movement. Mind you, I have a bad knee, completely metal, well, mostly metal, now.

CUT TO:

EXT. STREET - AFTERNOON

HUGH power walks down the street, one mechanical leg propelling him forward, moving robot-like, the other leg dragging behind weakened.

HUGH rushes through town, the background a blur.

HUGH's robot leg out performs the rest of his body, and he grows tired, weak, then terrified. He begins to scream asking for the propulsion of the leg to stop.

HUGH (CONTD') (O.S.)
So, just to shut her up, I go for walks—and don't ever tell her this, but I do enjoy them—its nice to get some sun on your skin when you're getting old—but how old do you have to get before you get to make decisions all on your own—about time I mind me and she minds her—love of my life, she is—but a real pain in the ass—so I go on

these walks, and where am I gonna walk to? There's no OBT around here, the parks are unbearable and hot. What, should I just go bake in the sun?

CUT TO:

INT. SUPERMARKET - AFTERNOON

HUGH wanders around the supermarket, offending everyone. Those he offends react in exaggerated manners. Their irritation propels them from HUGH's space like batteries of the same charge.

EL is also in the supermarket running from HUGH.

EL ducks into an aisle of health food thinking she is safe from the oppression of HUGH's rant.

On the opposite end of the aisle, EL notices the group of her bullies walking towards her. They all have weapons of destruction in their hands and blood in their eyes.

EL darts from the aisle to once again find HUGH, now an infectious disease of a human being, his orifices ooze.

The sight of HUGH terrifies everyone who comes into contact with him. Anyone in the supermarket who spots him, turns and runs as if he is infected by a terrible virus.

EL, the BULLIES, and the rest of the CROWD run in fear.

HUGH (CONT'D) (O.S.)
So, of course, I end up at the supermarket. Their lox are terrible by the way, I don't know what they do to their fish down here, but nothing like the delis home. I'm walking and I end up at the market and you know, of course, I'm just browsing to kill some time to keep Barb happy, but this walk needs to be fruitful, so I make a lap, pick up a basket, and before you know it the basket is fulled to the brim. You know, I don't even comprehend why they use those damned baskets cause you can't even fit a gallon of milk and a bottle of soda in their without breaking your arm. So I'm on my third lap now, and I got my basket in the wagon, and I'm hungry from my walk so my eyes are

of course bigger than my stomach ends up being. I told that nice colored boy behind the counter to slice the ham paper thin, and he let me try some, and it was pretty pretty thin, but maybe not thin enough. I didn't want to push it though. Figured, I didn't want to be thought of as picky. Though, I do believe it's important to get what I paid for, especially at these prices. I'm not complaining though. I can't wait to get home and make a nice ham sandwich with spicy mustard, have a side of some pickles and potato chips. And of course I got Barb some liverwurst. She would have my head, and some of my other parts too, if I come home with cold cuts and not liverwurst. Liverwurst sliced nice and thick. Very thick.

CUT TO:

INT. BARB AND HUGH'S APARTMENT / KITCHEN - DAY

HUGH, on his hands and knees, eats his ham sandwich from the dog bowl.

BARB and HUGH's dog, MADISON, sits in HUGH's seat at the dinner table across from BARB eating her dinner.

BARB leans over to wipe MADISON's mouth with fine napkin wear.

HUGH (CONTD') (O.S.)
What's funny is both her and and the dog eat it. She shoves the dogs seizure medication into it, folds it up, and the damned dog gobbles it up. Dumb dog.

CUT TO:

INT. BARB AND HUGH'S APARTMENT / BEDROOM - NIGHT

HUGH lies paraplegic in bed. He falls asleep, the room grows dark.

A CRACK OF LIGHT BREAKS THE DARKNESS. BARB's a shadow, and she sneaks over to HUGH lying in bed.

CLOSE ON HUGH's SLEEPING face.

BARB's SHADOW engulfs HUGH's FACE, pillow in her hand, then she SLAMS and HOLDS the pillow over HUGH's FACE.

HUGH awakens and struggles with as much might a parapalegic might summon.

HUGH (CONT'D) (O.S)
When she starts shoving my medicine in liverwurst is when I told her she should kill me, just pull the plug, put the pillow over my head, whatever the case. I don't wanna be a crippled who can't chew his own food and has to eat goddamned dog food. I have dignity. You heard that right, this old fart still has his dignity in tact! She wants to live to her last breath though. Keep her alive. That's what she says anyway. And never let anyone cut into her or take any kidneys or livers. She don't want her liver to end up in a gay. And she don't want to end up in the ground. She said she wants to get cooked up, turned to ash, and I gotta keep her in the house. I don't know that seems kinda creepy to me.

CUT TO:

INT. BARB AND HUGH'S APARTMENT / KITCHEN - EVENING

HUGH sits at the kitchen table with a steak dinner.

BARB's ASHES lie in an URN on the middle of the table. The lid of the URN lifts up and down, and BARB's voice pours out nagging HUGH as he attempts to swallow his dinner.

HUGH stands from his dinner, picks up the URN, and flings the URN against the wall.

The URN smashes and powder disperses into the air, the powder grows thicker and thicker.

HUGH chokes on the smoke, falls to his knees, and dies.

HUGH (CONTD') (O.S.)
Having your dead wife just sitting on the kitchen table while you're reading the paper and drinking coffee.

CUT TO:

EXT. STREET - AFTERNOON

EL and HUGH walk down the street, their apartment complex in sight. EL holds most of the bags, HUGH relinquishing much of the workload. The conversation, if it could be called that, picks up seamlessly as if the rant has never paused or ended.

HUGH
The buses are just nothing like they are back home. Let me tell you something, no where in the world do they do transport like they do in New York City. No where, not the Japs, not the British, not those damned Californians with all their traffic. That's not to say that we don't get a lot of traffic, especially when those fair-weather Floridians come and go with the seasons. But New York's subways system—It's flawless. Besides the rats. Korean's didn't even have trains when I was shipped off there. You know, when my kids were young, I worked hard, very hard, and I swore when Susie was born that I'd be able to afford to take them to Disney at least once a year.

CUT TO:

EXT. BARB AND HUGH'S APARTMENT - AFTERNOON

BARB and HUGH's apartment door opens and BARB steps out from overhearing the booming voice of her husband HUGH in the courtyard. BARB is also in her 70s, and is wearing one of those dresses that could also pass for a nightgown, she is also wearing high white socks and slip on sandals.

CUT TO:

INT. BARB AND HUGH'S APARTMENT - AFTERNOON

BARB rushes to the kitchen table to grab her pocketbook.

She fumbles through it to grab lipstick, quickly applies the lipstick in the mirror by the front door, and fixes up her hair.

She rummages through her purse for loose change. After finding a handful of change from the bottom of the purse, she dumps the quarters, and saves a few nickels in her palm.

CUT TO:

EXT. BARB AND HUGH'S APARTMENT - AFTERNOON

BARB opens the door to their apartment again in time to catch HUGH and EL just a few feet away.

Their little dog, MADISON slips out between BARB's feet and yips at HUGH and EL.

HUGH
Little rat!

BARB
Oh, look who it is! El, sweetheart, how'd he rope you into helping him? And don't call my baby a rat. I hope you bought some liverwurst.

HUGH
You think I want to hear your mouth? Of course, I bought liverwurst.

BARB
You told them nice and thick right?

HUGH
Yeah, I told them thick.

BARB
Did you hold up two fingers like I told you to do? Hold up two fingers, though yours are much fatter, and show them how thick?

HUGH doesn't answer BARB. He gives her a look.

BARB moves out of the way of the door to let both HUGH and EL into the apartment, and as they walk into the kitchen to drop off the groceries:

BARB (CONTD.)
Who'd you get cut the meat? Was it the slob Marianne? Or was it the sweet colored boy Danny?

HUGH
Danny.

BARB
(to EL)
Danny is such a sweet boy. Light skinned too. He knows just how I like my liverwurst.

EL kneels to the floor to play with MADISON.

EL wraps her in her arms and nuzzles MADISON's nose. This silences the dog's yapping.

BARB
Aw, my little sweetie loves you, El. She never calms down that easily, especially not with, old mister grumpy pants.

EL swings her backpack onto the front of her body, reaches in, and pulls out a notepad.

She writes down a note to BARB.

BARB (CONTD.)
Let me talk it over with Hugh. But I couldn't see why not. How could we say no to such a sweet girl?

EL smiles.

CUT TO:

EXT. APARTMENT COMPLEX - AFTERNOON

EL hangs a poster on the apartment complex BULLETIN BOARD.

GUS, an older mustachioed sleazeball, and owner of the apartment complex, escorts a young couple, ENRIQUE and NIKOLENA, both don a pair of shades and an itch they can't scratch.

The trios conversation is heard out of the frame before they enter the frame and then pass EL.

GUS
If you don't like the lot we just looked at, and you have some patience…we're going to be having some tenants moving out sooner then they might be expecting.

ENRIQUE
Looks like someone is up shit's creek.

GUS
And there ain't no paddle shop midway down this river, brothah.

NIKOLENA
How is…like, the crime around here?

The trio passes EL's backside, she turns and looks towards GUS.

GUS
Crime is like nonexistant, sistah. It's a real family environment, get me? We're all hard workers around here. All keep our noses down and out of each other's business.

GUS SNIFFLES and WIPES his NOSE.

GUS turns to look back at EL, EL looks away. GUS looks over EL, checking her out.

ENRIQUE catches GUS' glance.

ENRIQUE
Is that legal around these parts?

GUS
What's legal nowadays?

ENRIQUE
Old enough to pee, old enough for me.

NIKOLENA CACKLES. GUS and ENRIQUE FIST BUMP.

CUT TO:

EXT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT - EVENING

EL stands outside of SHEEN's apartment. SHEEN's APARTMENT DOOR FRAMES EL's smaller frame.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / LIVING ROOM - DAY

SHEEN lazes on the couch, scantily clad smoking a cigarette. DAVE walks into the frame, holding a big wrench.

DAVE
I fixed your toilet. Whoever said there aint no one whose shit don't stink…

SHEEN
…thanks.

DAVE
I'm pathetic and need to go out of town for a thing I don't care about because my wife owns me. Watch our retarded daughter, please? We can't pay you anything because we don't have any money.

DAVE laughs, then cries, crumpling to the ground he crawls over to SHEEN and licks her toes.

CUT TO:

EXT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT - EVENING

EL hesitates knocking on the door, she raises her hand to knock, lowers it then walks away, only before returning to raise her hand once more and then finally knocks.

EL fidgets awaiting SHEEN's arrival.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT/WORK SPACE - EVENING

SHEEN, with one hand, shoots spraypaint onto a canvas, with the other she smokes a fat blunt.

SHEEN hears the knock of the door, casually takes another hit, stands up from her seated position, looks towards her air freshener and decides within an instant that it is not worth concerning herself with.

SHEEN moves her way through the apartment and reaches to answer the door.

CUT TO:

EXT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT/FRONT DOOR - EVENING

EL quickly backs up as the front door to SHEEN's apartment swings open.

SHEEN leans against the frame of her doorway.

The CAMERA CUTS between them, first framing them separately and then as they move closer to one another captures them both in one frame.

SHEEN
Right on time, just as your pops said.

EL pulls out a card from her pocket, it reads: “hello, can you give me your cellphone number, please?”

SHEEN’s dog burst from between her legs. Her dog is named ALBERT EINSTEIN, but SHEEN calls her ALBIE for short.

ALBIE takes to EL immediately as EL drops to her knees and allows ALBIE to lick her face up.

SHEEN (CONTD.)
Albie, Albie, relax for christ’s sakes! Let off the girl. I’m sorry, El. Come on on inside.

EL rushes through the door and enters her home at the guidance of ALBIE who circles her movements, and then guides her to the kitchen.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN’S APARTMENT/KITCHEN - EVENING

SHEEN
What do they serve there at after school anyway: three day old pizza, sloppy who knows what meat, Jamaican beef pockets?

EL unloads her backpack and its content onto SHEEN’s table.

EL texts: “Jamaican Beef Patties. I like those.”

SHEEN looks to her phone, the text appears on the screen (similarly to subtitles).

SHEEN (CONTD.)
Patties, pockets. Don’t be pedantic. Pedantic is lame.

EL smiles at this sentiment.

Then writes: “I am hungry, if you don’t mind. And, I’m not picky at all. Whatever you have I’ll eat. I know how to cook too: tuna salad, Mac n cheese.”

SHEEN (CONTD.)
I have an idea. Since this is gonna be a two night affair, why don't you get your homework out of the way first, plant your behind on that table, do your schoolwork and then we have the next day and a half free to relax and do what we want. Does that sound fair?

EL nods her head approvingly.

SHEEN (CONTD.)
And in the meantime, I will make you and me some delicious Mac n cheese. But I will warn you that once you try my ultra special mega spectacular Mac n cheese you will never be able to taste that Kraft shit the same ever again without coming knocking on my door for the real stuff.

EL laughs.

SHEEN (CONTD.)
Girl, I'm not kidding you. This is like some super secretive samurai shit passed on down from my great grandma down to my grammy (skipping my mom because she was ungrateful, according to grammy), and fell down right onto me right before my grammy died. She used to make it for me when my mom used to leave me at her house all the time. This Mac n cheese will change your damn life, girl. Trust. Anyway, you make like a plant, finish your school work and then us girls will spend time doing whatever the hell we want. You like scary movies?

EL texts: "Not really…But I could try."

SHEEN (CONTD.)
We'll figure something out. Your choice.

SHEEN leaves EL to her work. While time elapses in hyper speed, we see that EL gets out some textbooks and does her homework. SHEEN in the foreground makes food, smokes cigarettes, and texts on her cellphone.

At one point during this time elapse, SHEEN's mouth moves sending some data EL's way, and SHEEN leaves frame. Time slows down.

CAMERA follows SHEEN leaving the kitchen, SHEEN leaves the apartment and closes the door behind her.

CUT TO EL sitting in the kitchen, suspicious.

She quickly turns around to the window covered in blinds, and peaks through the blinds to spy SHEEN getting in a YELLOW CORVETTE, only for a moment before quickly getting back out and heading back towards her apartment.

EL quickly turns around back to her schoolwork and pretends as though nothing has occurred as SHEEN walks back into the apartment and resumes her position at the stove stirring the Mac n Cheese.

Some time elapses.

SHEEN (CONTD.)
Hope your hungry.

EL looks up in approval.

SHEEN preps a bowl of her mind blowing Mac n Cheese, places it at the table in front of EL.

SHEEN (CONTD.)
Your tastebuds await heavenly bliss.

SHEEN hovers, waiting for EL to take a bite, which in time EL does. EL quickly shows a sign of praise.

SHEEN (CONTD.)
Well? What do you think?

EL texts: "Never Kraft again."

SHEEN offers EL a high five, and EL accepts.

SHEEN turns her back to EL to make herself her own bowl.

ALBIE appears from below the table.

ALBIE
Quick, while she isn't looking, give me a bite.

EL quickly hands over a spoonful of Mac n Cheese to ALBIE and ALBIE lingers for another.

EL
Play it cool, you're going to blow our cover.

SHEEN returns to the table with her own plate of food.

SHEEN stands behind EL, and she snaps a selfie of them together eating her self proclaimed famous Mac n Cheese.

SHEEN sits at the table, and plays around with her food, while EL finishes her bowl.

SHEEN takes her and EL's bowl, without ever taking a bite, and places it onto the counter before leaving the frame.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT/BEDROOM - EVENING

SHEEN is crouched on her floor, lotus position, sitting next to her bedside table.

SHEEN reaches into her bra, pulls out a baggie of three Percocet.

SHEEN grabs one, puts it into a one dollar bill, and using a lighter from the bedside table crushes the pill into a powder form. She pushes the powder onto her bedside table from the surface of the bill, cuts the powder into lines, rolls the bill and then snorts it.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / KITCHEN - EVENING

EL helps herself to a second helping of food.

EL sits at the kitchen table alone, eating a bowl of pasta by herself. She finished the bowl, and brings it to the kitchen sink, rinses the bowl, and places it in the dishwasher.

SHEEN walks in from off screen, a little bouncy.

SHEEN
Oh, you didn't need to do that.

EL nods that it is no trouble at all.

In the middle of the kitchen table sits a fruit bowl but without any fruit, in the bowl is an array of polaroids. Most of them are black, maybe there's the outline of a face or a hand, but for the most part they are all poorly lit and dim.

EL reaches into the bowl and starts looking at them more closely.

SHEEN (CONTD.
Those are all the rejects.

EL looks up to SHEEN, her face poses a question.

SHEEN (CONTD.)
Let's just say that when I have a polaroid camera in one hand, and a drink in another, I don't take the best pictures. Some come out cool. Some are shit. My friend Nat, is always trying to hide my camera when she comes over cause she says I'm such a waste. Polaroids are expensive.

SHEEN watches EL as she makes her way back to her work and packs up her homework.

SHEEN draws closer to the table without EL realizing, and she sees the open pages of EL's notebook.

CLOSE ON EL's NOTEBOOK which is filled with sketches and drawing, people SHEEN might recognize, the neighborhood, local stores, et cetera.

CLOSE ON a drawing of HUGH.

CLOSE ON a specific SKETCH of SHEEN COOKING.

SHEEN (CONTD.)
Girl, you can draw? I don't know why I'm asking. Girl, you can draw. God damn. How long you've been drawing?

On her notepad, EL writes: "Since I can remember."

SHEEN grabs EL's notebook, and skims through the pages.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / WORKSPACE - EVENING

EL enters SHEEN's workspace.

The entire perimeter of the room (the room parallels where EL's bedroom would be in her own house) is covered in canvas that is painted in graffiti art.

EL is astounded by SHEEN's work.

EL spins around taking in all of the artwork, ALBIE spins around her, and SHEEN watches from the doorway, taking it all in.

The joy unfolds for a few beats before we move on to another close up of SHEEN who smiles foggily.

ALBIE
I love watching her work.

SHEEN
If you like this, I have to take you to Wynwood some day soon.

EL turns to SHEEN with a confused look.

SHEEN looks up Wynwood on her iPhone and shows EL photos.

SHEEN (CONTD.)
An art district down in Miami. We can ride the tri-rail down there. With your parents permission of course. I think you'd be super into it. I'll be on one of those walls one day soon.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / BEDROOM - EVENING

SHEEN is next to her bedside again, continuing the process from before. This time, however, more lazily.

SHEEN reaches into her pocket counts cash, and then searches for her cellphone.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / WORKSPACE - EVENING

EL works on a blank canvas with spray paint. She paints with bright primary colors. ALBIE sits at her heels.

CUT TO:

EXT. APARTMENT COMPLEX - NIGHT

SHEEN saunters down a set of stairs and gets into the same yellow Corvette. The CAMERA lingers on the car, its tinted windows don't allow us to look in, and then SHEEN gets out and walks towards the CAMERA.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / KITCHEN - MORNING

EL eats a bowl of cereal.

SHEEN looks over different nail polishes at the kitchen table. SHEEN is in pajamas, lax, braless. There is an air of comfort between them that has grown more palpable.

EL texts: "Not hungry?"

SHEEN
Nope, I'm never hungry for breakfast. I am hungry to hear your opinion on what color I should paint our nails though.

EL texts: "Purple. Matches your hair."

SHEEN (CONTD.)
Imma do purple, with some specks of black. A purple fierce cheetah.
(she does a cat claw scratch)
Rawr! You want purple too? Or you want to pick your own color.

El texts: "Don't paint my nails. Sandra never took me."

SHEEN (CONTD.)
That's okay, cause I been painting my nails since I was six, so consider me a goddamn professional. Now pick a color and I'll make you fly as fuck.

EL gestures towards a color.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / WORKSPACE - AFTERNOON

CANVAS' POV

SHEEN works on some of her art.In the foreground, EL sits on the floor with some of her own work in front of her.

EL stops for a moment, pets ALBIE, and instead of working on her own work, she watches SHEEN working in her element.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S CAR - AFTERNOON

SHEEN is behind the wheel, smoking a cigarette with her window rolled down. EL is staring out the window with a reserved smile. Music plays on the radio, SHEEN sings along.

SHEEN
You're not gonna make me pick an ice cream flavor for you too, are you?

EL's cellphone begins to ping and at first SHEEN ignores the incoming messages, until it becomes a barrage of messages.

EL reaches into her pocket, pulls out her cellphone.

SHEEN (CONTD.)
Awfully popular this afternoon.

EL rolls her eyes and sticks her phone back in her pocket.

SHEEN (CONTD.)
Everything alright. Boy trouble?

EL pulls out her pen and paper, she writes: "Bitches from school. Annoying."

SHEEN (CONTD.)
Let me tell you something about bitches: they ain't gonna grow, they ain't gonna change, maybe they'll get pregnant, maybe they'll marry the same guys they've been fucking since they were 16. They're going nowhere and nowhere fast, sweetie.

EL smiles at this insight.

SHEEN (CONTD.)
So keep your chin up, and remember that whoever high school is hardest for ends up on the other end thriving. I got knocked around by some bitches in high school cause they had nice new Jordans and I had Payless shoes and Walmart shirts. And now look at me, I'm cool, right? Oh, god, I never thought I'd ask if I was cool. I'm getting old, aren't I? Fuck, now I sound like my dad.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / LIVING ROOM - AFTERNOON

EL sits on the floor in the living room, the television on, and EL catches up on some correspondence with her blog followers.

Silhouettes of SHEEN and their neighbor JEANNIE are framed by the window. JEANNIE is a middle aged woman, on her second marriage to a much younger man, WALTER. JEANNIE's first husband committed suicide in their basement after 9/11.

At first, EL pays no mind, but when their voices raise EL is distracted and then MUTES the television to hear what they are saying.

JEANNIE (O.S.)
If we keep seeing all these random shades walking up and down our halls, I'm going to report you.

SHEEN (O.S.)
Oh, are you, bitch?

JEANNIE (O.S.)
Yes, I most certainly will. And believe me, bitch, I'm not the only one who notices all the comings and goings from your front door. Having trouble making rent?

SHEEN (O.S.)
No, I'm fucking not. Fuck, why am I even answering, you're not my goddamn mom. How I make rent is none of your business.

JEANNIE (O.S.)
Watch your tone, young lady…you don't want to fuck with me, I'm from New York and I fight fucking dirty, cunt.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT/BEDROOM - NIGHT

EL and SHEEN are laying on SHEEN's bed, they are close. A light from a film plays across their face. EL is wide awake, absorbing. SHEEN is barely awake, but content. We linger here.

SHEEN slowly falls entirely asleep.

It takes awhile for EL to notice, but after sometime her eyes dart to SHEEN checking on her, she notices her asleep.

EL slowly and carefully maneuvers to unleash a blanket from somewhere off screen, then covers SHEEN's sleeping body.

CUT TO:

EXT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT - AFTERNOON

EL and SHEEN stand just outside of SHEEN's apartment door. EL is packed up and is on the way out to head back home.

She kneels down to say goodbye to ALBIE, then stands again to meet SHEEN at eye level.

SHEEN
It was fun, chick! We need to do it again, and don't feel like your parents need to be out of town for us to spend time together. I fun working with another super talented girl. Us girls will rule the world one day. You can bet your bottom dollar. And oh, almost forgot—

SHEEN darts back inside, and returns quickly with a key ring. She sorts through her keys and hands EL a key.

SHEEN (CONTD.)
Okay, here's the rules: I'm trusting you with this key, so please just text me before you come over. At night and on the weekends I usually won't be here, and I can't really look at my phone when I'm behind the bar, so if I don't answer and you need to pick up Albie, no worries.

EL and SHEEN embrace.

SHEEN holds on for a little bit longer than EL.

SHEEN goes back inside and closes the door.

EL starts off towards her apartment, turns back towards SHEEN's to sneak a goodbye peek and sees that ALBIE is poking his nose through the blinds to spy her leaving.

ALBIE barks a few times and EL smiles.

CUT TO:

EXT. STREET - DAY

EL walks down the street with ALBIE and MADISON each on their own leash, one leash in each hand.

QUICK CUT TO:

EXT. STREET - DAY

EL walks down the same street with ALBIE and MADISON, and now a third dog, TOZER. ALBIE and MADISON are leashed in one of EL's hands, TOZER in the other.

QUICK CUT TO:

EXT. STREET - DAY

EL walks down the same street, with ALBIE, MADISON, and TOZER, but now with addition of GABRIEL MAGNUS, PRINCESS VICTORIA, and BOO. EL is being pulled along by the sheer force of the dogs, a force that she embraces and doesn't mind being pulled by.

CUT TO:

EXT. PARK - DAY

EL holding back the dogs from ripping her arms off and scuffling with the other dogs in the park. The dogs clash, but it is friendly, and playful.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN's APARTMENT/BATHROOM - NIGHT

EL is giving ALBIE a bath. ALBIE splashes EL, soaking her down to the bone.

CUT TO:

INT. COLLEGE KID'S APARTMENT / LIVING ROOM - EVENING

EL awaits one of the kids to bring the leash for their communal dog. The kids are yelling back and forth asking where the leash is.

CUT TO:

EXT. BACKYARD - AFTERNOON

EL is hosing down the gang of pups in a closed in backyard.

CUT TO:

EXT. PARK - EVENING

EL unravels some plastic bags from one of the leashes and tries to stoop down to pick up some dog waste before being yanked away off frame, to only force her way back into frame and just reach the dog poo.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT/BEDROOM - EVENING

EL denies another dog walking customer. She scrolls through some photos of her being photographed with a customer's dog, citing her as the best dog walker.

CUT TO:

EXT. GARY'S APARTMENT - EVENING

GARY, 40's, construction worker, asks EL how much it cost to feed his dog in the morning's before she heads to school.

CUT TO:

EXT. DOG PARK - EVENING

EL fights her way through multiple gate barriers with all the dogs in tow trying to make her way into the dog park. She plays fetch. Tries to break up a dog fight.

CUT TO:

INT./EXT. MULTIPLE LOCATIONS - DIFFERENT TIMES

EL collects her pay from her clients, quick cutting from client to client.

CUT TO:

INT. BARB AND HUGH'S APARTMENT/KITCHEN - EVENING

BARB stands by the stove, casually stirring some food. HUGH sit at the kitchen table, in his undershorts, smoking a cigarette.

HUGH
I hear the damned mutt yapping. He's close. You better go let her in and let the girl know you ain't paying her.

BARB
I'm not the one not paying her. You are. So you better go tell the girl that we can't pay here this week.

HUGH
I'm not telling the girl a god damned thing. You wanted her to take care of the mutt, you go and tell her. I'm not embarrassing myself. I still have some dignity, you know.

BARB
The mutt has a name, you old grouch. And if you'd be nice to Madison, she wouldn't be walking around in a terror all day that you're gonna beat the poor thing till it pisses on the floor.

HUGH
Tell your poor thing that if she stays out of my way, I'll stay out of hers and everything will be a whole lot more peaceful around here, you hear?

There's a knock at the door.

HUGH peaks out from the blinds.

HUGH
And she got the druggies dog in tow too.

BARB
Go put some pants on, you slob. I'm inviting that sweet girl in for some food at least. No more smoking in the kitchen. Go, go, hurry now.

BARB walks over to the table to shoo HUGH and waves her arm in the air to shoo the smoke from the cigarette.

CUT TO:

EXT. BARB AND HUGH'S APARTMENT - EVENING

EL is in front of BARB and HUGH's apartment. She has ALBIE and MADISON in tow.

BARB opens the front door.

BARB
Sweetie, sweetie, thank you for delivering our little girl. Hope she was well behaved.

EL nods.

BARB (CONTD.)
Please come in for some dinner.

EL signals towards ALBIE. Its clear that she'd rather not, but that subtlety is lost on BARB.

BARB (CONTD.)
Don't worry, you could bring Albie in. Please, come in, we insist.

EL hesitates.

BARB reaches out and grabs EL shoulder to usher her into the apartment.

BARB closes the front door.

EL lets ALBIE go and he goes barreling into their apartment.

EL and BARB linger by the front door.

BARB (CONTD.)
Here's the story, sweetie:
(in a hushed voice)
we actually can't afford to pay you this week, Hugh is waiting on…
(whispers)
the check.
(raises her voice a bit more)
So please consider this a down payment on how well you've been treating our baby. She hasn't been this lively since she was a tiny puppy. And god knows, she hasn't smelled this nice since ever.

BARB ushers EL along to the kitchen. HUGH has returned to his post, he is reading the newspaper, glasses on the bridge of his nose, squinting. He doesn't acknowledge their entrance into the kitchen.

ROUND OF APPLAUSE as EL walks into the kitchen.

EL smiles at the CAMERA and waves.

BARB (CONTD.)
Honey, El is going to join us for dinner. She said the food smelt so good, she couldn't resist. Don't be rude, Hugh, say hello.

HUGH
Hello, dear. How's school?

HUGH asks his question, quickly returning the paper to blocking his face from the rest of them.

CANNED LAUGHTER.

BARB
Hugh, tell El how sweet our puppy has been, how much energy she has had since she started walking her a few weeks ago.

HUGH
Yeah. Sweet. Very sweet.

MADISON yips at HUGH's feet. HUGH without thought begins to beat the dog with the paper he has in his hands.

CANNED LAUGHTER.

BARB
Honey, take a seat. Make yourself at home. Dinner will be ready soon.

HUGH
Better be. Or I'll knock you the fuck out.
(to EL)
Ask my first wife.

CANNED LAUGHTER.

BARB
Oh hush.

HUGH shoots BARB a glance.

BARB shivers in the corner.

CANNED LAUGHTER.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT/KITCHEN - EVENING

SANDRA is working on putting together a lesson plan on the kitchen table, she takes a moment to sort through some of her students papers. DAVE stands by the stove tending to dinner.

DAVE
Eh, screw it. Move on. You don't get paid enough to care. You know me, work only as hard as you're paid.

SANDRA
Maybe that's why you got 'let go,' Dave.

DAVE
For fuck's sake, Sandra, I got let go because no one can afford to put in any fucking windows in this neighborhood, let alone a hundred mile radius. Home Depot took all the work from Stan so then Stan had to cut people—

SANDRA
Dave, I heard this before. It's been 2 months since Home Depot, or Stan, or whoever, ruined your life. Move on or move out. Maybe your black cloud will follow you and keep its rain off of me.

DAVE
Sure, Sandra. Whatever you say. Here try this pasta.
(he holds up a label with a noodle on it)
A little more?

SANDRA
Leave it on for another minute or so. I like it a—

DAVE
Softer, I know. After this I gotta go to the college kids apartment. Those little bastards better tip.

SANDRA
Kids don’t know what tipping is. They especially don’t tip old men.

DAVE
El will. At least I hope she will know to have some respect. You know, there’s nothing more important than respect in this world.

SANDRA
Sure, Dave. Where is El?

DAVE walks over the fridge.

CLOSE ON a laminated Excel sheet with EL’s dog walking schedule on it, DAVE’s finger finds the right day and hour.

DAVE
She should’ve been home forty five minutes ago.

For the first time this entire conversation, SANDRA looks up from her work.

SANDRA
That girl is never late.

DAVE
She’s fine. She’s always been fine.

CUT TO:

EXT. APARTMENT COMPLEX - NIGHT

EL and ALBIE walk towards SHEEN’s apartment.

EL stops and drops to a knee to search for SHEEN’s key in her backpack.

Police lights suddenly spark and beat against the apartment structure and across EL and ALBIE’s face and body.

ALBIE notices immediately, EL takes a second before she lifts her head towards the assault of lights.

EL slowly stands backup, and her and ALBIE continue towards SHEEN’s apartment hesitantly.

TWO POLICE OFFICERS walk up a flight of stairs and head in the same direction, the OFFICERS and EL and ALBIE both walk from a distance facing each other.

They beat EL and ALBIE to SHEEN's front door, which causes EL to stutteringly back away from her destination as the OFFICER's knock on the door a handful of times.

We track EL and ALBIE's movements as she doubles back and down a flight of stairs to watch from some shrubbery that obscures her and ALBIE from sight.

A couple of rounds of knocks followed by more and more aggressive shouting plays out before the OFFICERS barge their way into SHEEN's apartment.

Another handful of police cars arrive, along with an ambulance, and a fire truck.

EL receives a text from Dave: "Are you almost home, dinner is getting cold? We talked about this. Mom says when dinner is cleaned up the kitchen is closed."

EL and ALBIE linger, before—

EL books it with ALBIE from her hiding place up a flight of stairs and towards her apartment.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT/KITCHEN - NIGHT

SANDRA removes the places at the table.

DAVE scrubs dishes at the kitchen sink.

EL bursts in, clearly distraught.

SANDRA
What's the hold up, El? Why is that dog with you? If you're going to be out this late, we don't know if this is the best idea for you doing this dog walking business. We can't see your grades go down. And we're a family. We eat together.

DAVE
You know the rules.

SANDRA
We spoke about this. You need to set boundaries with these peoples. Cash up front, strict timelines, no dinners instead of pay.

EL types into her cellphone, sending them a group message: "Sheen's in trouble. Cops are outside of her apartment."

DAVE and SANDRA's cells ping.

DAVE
Hands are wet. Can you read it out loud.

SANDRA
She says that Sheen's in trouble. There are cops outside her place. Who is Sheen again?

DAVE
The girl whose apartment I worked in a few weeks ago, broken shower head—El stayed at her place.

SANDRA stares into DAVE's soul.

SANDRA (CONTD.)
The police are outside the girl's house who you, Dave, had babysit our girl? The girl you vouched for, the girl you said seems like a stand up citizen of our neighborhood.

DAVE
For all you know it could be a parking summons.

SANDRA
For all you know it could be a Russian spy.

DAVE
Typical for you to jump to that conclusion. All I saw was a girl who was a painter who might've related to another girl who was a painter. Typical for you to judge that.

EL flustered by the conversation turning from her concerns into a shouting match, texts: "Can someone go find out what is happening?"

DAVE
Read it to me again, Sandra.

SANDRA places a stack of plates next to the sink, and walking out of the room, says:

SANDRA
Read it yourself.

DAVE wipes his hands and reads the text message.

EL stares at him, waiting for his response, eyes watering. The sirens beat in through the slits in the blinds.

DAVE
El, I wouldn't worry yourself about this. Don't be like your mother, worst case isn't always the case.

EL texts: "Sandra is not my mother."

EL and ALBIE exit the room.

DAVE is left standing in the kitchen.

The CAMERA tracks him leaving the apartment.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / EL'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

EL sits on her bed, her knees in her chest, she's staring directly at the CAMERA. ALBIE is perched next to her.

EL waits for the sirens and the chaos to die down.

O.S. we hear the front door slam closed.

DAVE fumbles around the apartment, washes his hands, heads down the hallway, and knocks on EL's bedroom door.

EL stands from her seated position and moves to open the door a crack for DAVE to see a part of her face.

DAVE
Can I come in?

EL doesn't open the door any further for him to enter.

DAVE (CONTD.)
Okay. It's not good. She's dead. Her dog can stay for a few nights, but you need to find him a new home. I'm allergic.

EL closes the door on DAVE.

Walks over to the bed, and then slumps over and onto it.

ALBIE sensing EL's despair hops up onto the bed and begins nuzzling and licking her face.

EL wraps ALBIE in an embrace.

EL
It's not okay now, but it will be soon. This is just the sad part of the movie. Justice will be served.

O.S. we can hear the muffled arguing of SANDRA and DAVE.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / SANDRA AND DAVE'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

DAVE sits knees to chest in the corner, whimpering.

SANDRA imposes from the bed, on all fours, screaming, and wagging her finger down to DAVE.

DAVE
Blah, blah, blah, blah, I'm pathetic, I'm a loser.

SANDRA
You killed her, didn't ya? Spineless. You always wanted to fuck her, fuck anything that walks. Couldn't control yourself?

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / EL'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

EL sets an alarm on her phone.

EL and ALBIE embrace each other as time speeds up, EL and ALBIE both fall in and and out of sleep, and after some time the sirens from outside die down and the room becomes pitch black.

EL's phone lights up and her alarm blares for a moment, both her and ALBIE jump awake in the darkened bedroom.

EL turns the lights on, and suits up. She slips socks onto ALBIE's feet so his nails don't pitter patter as they sneak out of the apartment.

The CAMERA tracks behind EL and ALBIE as they sneak through the hall towards SANDRA and DAVE's room. The television is blasting, which is a good sign as she continues on her trek.

She tracks the hallway, being quiet and careful, ALBIE follows closely at her feet—if she pauses for a moment, so does ALBIE.

EL carefully opens the front door, slips her and ALBIE out through it, then closes it with the doorknob pre-turned so it doesn't make any sound as it closed.

She locks the door behind her.

CUT TO:

EXT. APARTMENT COMPLEX - NIGHT

EL and ALBIE move through the complex sticking to the shadows and avoiding the moonlight—EL knows that there are eyes everywhere in the neighborhood.

EL and ALBIE arrive at SHEEN's front door. Crime scene tape covers the frame of the door. For a moment, EL searches for her key, but ALBIE pushes in with his nose through the front door as the lock been busted by the forceful entry of the police.

EL, shocked, quickly follows inside, she slips underneath the crime scene tape careful not to disturb it then closes the door behind her.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

LONG TAKE: The CAMERA follows EL and ALBIE as they track their way through the apartment quickly and efficiently.

Nothing is out of place. Everything is in order.

EL takes a moment to feed ALBIE, who has been lapping up water in the background.

When they get to the bedroom, CLOSE ON their silhouettes on the closed bedroom door, then as the door swings open, CLOSE ON a disturbed and disrupted bed.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / BEDROOM - NIGHT

EL, equipped with cellphone (not emotions), starts snapping pictures of everything she sees around her.

She snaps photos of the bed, and finds some speckles of blood stained into the sheets.

She takes pictures of the bedside tables which have some drug baggies, tobacco, faint traces of powder, and provocative polaroids.

Stay CLOSE ON the disheveled bedside table as EL exits the frame.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / WORKSPACE - NIGHT

EL heads down the hallways and into the WORKSPACE.

She takes snaps of all SHEEN's artwork. ALBIE enters the frame.

CLOSE ON a piece of artwork that portrays violence and rape, yet also seems seductive and powerful.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / KITCHEN - NIGHT

EL moves towards the kitchen, and she notices a bunch of polaroids are posted and splayed all along the refrigerator. The polaroids contain a random splattering of young adults and some other random strange individuals.

EL makes a digital snapshot of all of them before disturbing any of them.

FLASH CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

The PARTIES depicted in the photos comes alive and EL is able to move through the party as if she was there.

EL looks around the smoke filled apartment, music blasting, SHEEN's jumping up and down, camera in hand.

The front door opens, SHEEN yells at the entrance of a new visitor, walks up to him/her and starts to make out with them.

SHEEN
We've been waiting for you, motherfucker!

EL at first disturbed, then moves on into the other parts of the apartment.

In the living room, a group of kids are playing a card game and passing around two nice and thick blunts.

One of the partiers, sitting a bit distant from the others in a love seat crushes up some narcotics and sniffs it before offering the drugs to a buddy.

GARY enters from the hallway into the party, sticking out like a sore thumb as an older middle aged man surrounded by younger people, his style is off from the rest of the party, he's bald or balding—EL immediately spots him and notes the creepy appearance of the 40+ year old at a 20 year olds house party.

GARY takes a seat next to one of the younger woman and instantly begins to manhandle her, placing his hands all over her. She is drunken and resistant, but gives into his forcefulness. GARY grabs her breast and shoves his hand down her pants. The crowd cheers.

SAL enters moments after the last entrance of the last visitor. SAL wears a yellow biker outfit, similarly to the outfit we've seen in the first few moments of the film.

SAL and SHEEN embrace, they look comfortable with one another. There is an exchange of cash between the two of them that is obvious.

SHEEN leads SAL into the hallway and into her bedroom. EL pauses then follows them.

EL hesitates outside of the doorway, she hears no discernible sound. She tries to open the door.

GARY comes rushing down the hallway.

EL falls to the floor as GARY's immense force knocks the wind out of her.

GARY bangs and knocks on SHEEN's door, yelling and hollering.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / KITCHEN - NIGHT

CUT BACK TO EL ALONE IN THE KITCHEN standing in front of the fridge.

This level of intimacy between all the patrons of the party spurs EL to notice a pattern in the photos.

Once EL notices that SHEEN seems to intimately posed with more than just SAL, with both man and woman alike. We quickly see a photo of SHEEN lip locked with a female, the top of their faces cut off by the frame of the polaroid.

Using the reference photo she took before disturbing the pictures, she rearranges all the photos she disturbed in her digital documentation of the analogue polaroids.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / EL'S BEDROOM - EARLY MORNING

EL and ALBIE lay under the blankets of EL's bed. EL has her laptop opened, while her cellphone uploads all the photos onto her desktop.

She collects all the files on her desktop into a folder called: "Evidence."

A knock at the door disturbs her.

EL lowers the light on her screen.

ALBIE gets excited, EL hushes him.

DAVE (O.S.)
Time to wake up sweetie.

EL peeks out from underneath the covers to spy that it is day already. Simultaneously, her alarm goes off.

She hops out of bed and over to her window, and watches the parking lot down below. She notices that GARY's truck isn't in the parking lot.

CUT TO:

INT. GARY'S TRUCK - NIGHT

Both of GARY's large hands grip the wheel, he's burning rubber, pedal to the metal on a dark and long highway. GARY, paranoid as all Hell, checks around, neck tweaking.

CLOSE ON GARY's reflection in the rear view mirror, his eyes jut to the right. PAN to a bloodied rope and knife lying in the driver's seat.

SIRENS appear in his rear view mirror.

GARY's eyes jerk back to the rear view mirror. He starts to silently cry.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / KITCHEN - MORNING

EL is gobbling down cereal, her laptop propped in front of her, and she is laser focused. She is uploading a batch of photos to her blog…

…and writing a post asking her followers for help making connections between all of the evidence she has collected. She doesn't post it right away, instead she spends time deciding on the right phrasing.

DAVE enters and EL closes her laptop, and takes the rest of the cereal into her mouth by lifting the bowl and swishing the remains with big gulps to hurry out of the kitchen.

DAVE notices ALBIE.

DAVE
Oh, yeah, the dog. El, make sure you're proactive in finding a home for him. He can stay a few nights but that's it. Sandra is allergic and I think I might be too, honestly.

EL sends ALBIE a look that he doesn't have to go anywhere, she is going to take care of him.

DAVE (CONTD.)
The landlord is kicking me some extra money to clean out Sheen's apartment. I'll save some of the dog toys and bring them over here while you're in school. Speaking of which, you think we can chain this dog up outside while you're gone?

EL grabs her cellphone to text DAVE, DAVE preemptively reaches for his cellphone to await her response.

EL writes: "Too hot out today. He is an inside dog."

EL hesitates, then sends this next: "Don't the police need to find the killer first before you throw away evidence?"

DAVE (CONTD.)
The officer says they've seen this type of thing over and over again around here. Nothing was fishy. They seemed pretty sure, and we should just trust them—they are the police after all, and they know way more about this then me or you. Believe me.

EL begins to tear up with anger. Her hands clench, her nails dig into the flesh of her palms.

DAVE embraces EL from behind as she is seated in the kitchen chair, then quickly leaves the kitchen to avoid any further awkward confrontation.

As soon as DAVE exits the frame, EL moves over to a kitchen drawer, opens it, and pulls out a photocopied list of all the tenants, their phone numbers, and their emails (where applicable).

O.S. we hear the sounds of someone drawing close.

SANDRA (O.S.)
Honey, are you in the kitchen?

EL quickly snaps a photo, drops the paper back into the drawer, closes it, spins around and awaits the arrival of SANDRA.

Her face shifts from determined to detrimental. She is playing them.

SANDRA
Good morning. I'm about to head off to work. Please try and find a place to send the dog, he can stay a few nights, I wouldn't mind having him, but Dave's allergic.

SANDRA gives EL a kiss on the cheek goodbye before leaving the kitchen and heading out the door.

CUT TO:

INT. PUBLIC TRANSIT / BUS - MORNING

EL parks herself in the same seat she was sitting in the last time we saw her on the bus.

EL pulls up her photo of the photocopied contact list, finds the name of the two college kids listed on the sheet, TEDDY and SUSAN.

She finds both of their profiles on social media, then searches through their friends list to find the other remaining three, NICOLE, OMAR, and MICAH. The college kids apartment shares a wall with SHEEN's apartment.

EL sends an email to all of them asking them when would be a good time for them to all meet. EL pretends she is doing some type of social study project and needs their input on the project.

EL sends an email requesting the parking lot camera footage from the last few days from the tenants of the apartment complex.

EL switches tasks, and begins to crop out all of the faces from the photos she collected, naming the ones she knows and leaving the faces she does not know unlabeled.

CUT TO:

EXT. PUBLIC SCHOOL / PLAYGROUND - AFTERNOON

From the same familiar position we found EL seated in during her high school recess at the beginning of the film, we find her in the same position once again. EL has a penchant for sameness. Far from the festivities of high school lunch lazing, laptop on her lap, a set of earbuds firmly locked into her ears, and munching on apple slices. This time she is drafting a questionnaire to hand out to her suspects and people of interest in her neighborhood.

CLOSE ON LAPTOP SCREEN as she begins to type the questions into a word processor. She spends time with the language of each question, sometimes backspacing and rewording, sometimes rapidly beating the words onto the screen with sureness.

The text below, as long with the questions, are read aloud by an amalgamation of the actors voices from the film. The voices shift and out from one another.

“I am conducting a series of interviews regarding the death of our neighbor. I have my suspicions that a murder has taken place right under our noses. Any information you can give me would really be helpful in serving justice.”

A) What is your cellphone number? NOTE: Please read it nice and slowly so I have a moment to type it into my phone.

B) May I record this for my records?

C) What is <u>her</u> name? (PICTURE of SHEEN)

D) What’s your alibi for Wednesday night, December Twentieth, 2017?

E) Any suspects or persons of interest?

F) Have you noticed a yellow corvette visiting the parking lot anytime over the past week?

G) Impressions of Sheen as a member of our society.

H) Are there any other thoughts or facts that you would like to reveal to me regarding the incident? Anything you might like to add that I have not explicitly asked in this questionnaire?

I) Why should I not consider you a suspect?

EL'S POV:

The CAMERA PULLS BACK from the CLOSE UP of the computer SCREEN. The SCREEN is still in focus, but now we can see the blurred action surrounding EL that she has been ignoring as she's been locked into the task at hand.

The CAMERA PULLS back even further until we are behind EL's shoulder.

BLURRED SHAPES approach EL from directly in front of her.

The SCREEN of the laptop suddenly SLAMS CLOSED by a bracelet wearing, finger painted HAND that is revealed as the SCREEN shifts from OPEN to CLOSED in front of the CAMERA.

EL, at first distracted by her task, is caught off guard, her laptop slips to the concrete floor from the rough nature of the handling, ripping her earbuds from her ears, and makes an unfortunate crack as it hits the floor.

EL, still ignoring her surroundings, drops to the floor to inspect her computer. We can hear the drowned out sounds of dialogue from teenage girls beginning to take shape, however, this is all moving in slow motion. EL lifts up her computer, spins around, placing it on the bench, opens the computer and it is restored to its last state before it fell, now with a CRACK running through the middle of the SCREEN. However, EL has not lost any of her work.

CAMERA CUTS to a small crowd of teenage girls forming a circle around the bench that EL kneels around. CAMERA spins around them, creating a claustrophobic net around EL.

The girls names are: MIA, EMILY, ALANI, ANDREA, and CHLOE. MIA is the ring leader.

MIA

I don't know what you're worried about. Your piece of shit computer was already broken. That's why you were ignoring us, right? The messages weren't getting through to you, right? Right?

EMILY
That seems to be the only explanation. Only logical one, anyhow.

ANDREA
Unless she just all broken herself.

ALANI
Doesn't make sense that this bitch would ignore us. Us. We fucking royalty up in this motherfucker.

EMILY
Well, this bitch is always on that stupid computer. Maybe it's her only friend and she don't want no real friends. Maybe she happy being all alone jerking off to chat bots.

MIA
There is no doubt about that. Ain't nothing scary on that screen that can't get closed down when powered off. What you afraid of, dummy? Real life? My heel?

ANDREA
Nope no doubt you should be afraid of Mia's heel. You don't wanna make no other friends? You like having no friends?

MIA
So you think when this group of bitches reaches out to this scrawny nasty bitch, she'd be dying to make friends with us. Real people. You scared of people? Your step dad fuck you when you were little?

CHLOE
Mia, maybe she ain't just deaf and dumb, but blind too.

ALANI
Yeah, maybe the bitch can't read.

MIA
Is that true, bitch? You don't know words?

EMILY
That would make sense. Yeah, maybe she don't know how to write either. She's probably retarded.

MIA
Probably? Definitely.

EL is still crouched on the ground, she allows the girls surrounding her to continue their berating of her, she allows them to keep their power, eyes to the floor, and quickly packing her backpack.

MIA
You would think this retarded bitch would be more than excited to wanna talk to us, right?

EMILY
Retard!

CHLOE
Fucking retard! Look at us when we're talking to you!

ALANI
You don't wanna be our friend?

MIA
Obviously, she don't wanna be our friend. And even if she wanted to be our friend now, the invitation has officially been rescinded.

ANDREA
Mia was being nice and generous when she suggested we invite your simple ass to our group chat.
(to Emily)
Sorta like when your brother Frankie helped out at the special olympics.

MIA
Generous as fuck, bitch. That is over with. Now you better watch yourself as you're walking through the halls. You better watch how you looking at us. Yeah, keep your eyes down or we'll blind you, cunt.

MIA starts poking and prodding EL as she is on the floor, who to this point has showed no sign of fear.

MIA
We'd smash your face in now but—

EMILY
Mia can't get no more strikes on her record.

MIA sends a sharp glance to EMILY.

EL stands up suddenly and stares directly into MIA's eyes, first with fire, then with a smile, then with a tight and overbearing hug, and then pushes right past her with speed and might and certainty.

CLOSE ON the group of girls as EL hustles down the block and into the foreground of the frame, she turns, still with a big smile, and waves back to her antagonizers.

The rest of the girls await MIA's next move as they are all frozen by EL's display of warmth and affection at the crossroads of anger and spite.

MIA
That bitch is fucking crazy.

MIA has an unlit cigarette in her mouth, she cocks her hand out and silently asks for one of the other girls to hand her a light. One of the others, instead of handing her a lighter, lights the cigarette in her mouth.

EMILY
She don't know who she is speaking to. We ain't gonna let her get away with that disrespect.

MIA sends another sharp glance to EMILY.

The YELLOW CORVETTE pulls up behind the girls in the background.

CUT TO:

INT. BAKERY - AFTERNOON

NO AUDIO. MUSIC TRACK.

SHARON works behind the bakery counter. She tends to a short line of patrons. From behind the counter, we see through the bakery's front glass windows EL entering the frame.

CUT TO:

EXT. BAKERY - AFTERNOON

NO AUDIO. MUSIC TRACK CONTINUES.

EL kills time outside of the bakery, hits the toes of her shoes against the cement sidewalk, walks in circles, does some jumps up and down, checks her phone. In the bakery, we can see SHARON finishing her duty to the patron's of the shop and the line shortens until no one is left in the bakery.

CUT TO:

INT. BAKERY - AFTERNOON

SHARON
Oh, it's that time of the day already, huh? I never realize how much of the day has passed me by until your sweet face shows up and then I realize the whole day has just ran on by. Same as always?

EL gestures that SHARON's assumption is correct.

SHARON moves around the counter to get EL's daily order. EL drops to a knee, whips out her laptop, opens it, and places it onto the counter top.

SHARON (CONTD.)
The bread arrived a little late this morning, so the driver gave me an extra bundle of French twist. Give this to your mother, tell her Sharon says hello, you here.

SHARON hands over a bag of bread to EL.

SHARON (CONTD.)
Oh, what is this?

SHARON sees the laptop opened. But she can't read it as her eyes are bad.

SHARON (CONTD.)
Is there something on here that you want me to read?

EL gestures to the computer.

SHARON (CONTD.)
Alright, alright, hold on. Let me get my reading glasses, sweetie. Hm, what is this? The screen is black, sweetie. And my, what a nasty crack you got running right down the middle. You should get that fixed.

EL reaches for the laptop, spins it around, moves the mouse to bring the computer back to life. She makes sure the questionnaire is the only thing on the screen that SHARON can see.

SHARON begins to read the introduction to herself, she mouths the words, and sometimes says some of the words out loud. She arrives at the first question.

SHARON (CONTD.)
Okay, number A. Well, you already have my cellphone number, so moving right along.

SHARON looks up from the screen and smiles at EL. EL returns a fired off smile of her own.

CLOSE ON SHARON as she tries and makes out the questions, she struggles to read the words on the screen. She speaks slowly, piecing the words together.

SHARON (CONTD.)
Okay now, number B. Record me? Oh, my. I always hated the sound of my own voice. You ever call someone on the phone and get that feedback where you can hear your own voice, then ask yourself: jeez is that what I sound like? Ugh, what a nag. I'd rather you not record me. Okay, yeah, she's the girl who lived next door. She lives next to that racket of a college dorm room. She's a bit of a whore, no? Sleeps around with the whole neighborhood. God bless her and paint an 'A' on her forehead for the world to see and steer clear of. She comes in here a lot, but if it was my bakery we wouldn't serve the likes of her. No, this neighborhood don't need nothing like that.

CUT TO:

INT. CHURCH - DUSK

SHEEN lies tied up and splayed out on the altar, passed out.

A CULT of HOODED FIGURES circle her body, chanting:

HOODED FIGURES
Though She is not a virgin / He has never had no aversion / To feed His blood perversion.

SHEEN wakes from her drugged slumber, starts screaming and struggling.

One of the HOODED FIGURES steps closer to the altar, pulls back the hood of the cloak, revealing SHARON. In SHARON's hand she holds a swiveled dagger.

CLOSE on DAGGER (HITCHCOCK PSYCHO KNIFE CLOSE UP).

CUT TO:

INT. BAKERY - AFTERNOON

STAY CLOSE ON EL, her patience a virtue, as SHARON continues to answer, but takes many an aside to ramble and rant.

SHARON (CONTD.)
Hm, last night? Well, I remember being home for Jeopardy, Family Feud, and Wheel. I got one of the Jeopardy questions right and was so excited I decided to treat myself to a helping of marble cake with a hefty scoop of fluff. This is all okay, of course, for my diabetes because it was low sugar and I haven't had any cake in over a week. But no, I don't really remember anything funny happening that night. I was eating my cake and then just heard all the hullabaloo happening down the way. That girl and those college kids were always bringing dark characters around the apartment. Anytime you see a cigarette butt you know who to attribute it to. Well, this is the reason I can't wait to hit 55 so I can move to a retired community. So sick of the disrespect. I woke up one morning to a nice big old scratch across my car. One of those little bastards must've just taken a key and scratched it for the fun of it. Who would scratch a poor old ladies car? If it was up to me, I'd wring em up all by their necks.

The sound of a bell is heard O.S., this is the sound of a customer coming into the bakery. A blurred shape enters the frame. CLOSE ON SHARON as she lifts the computer and hands it to EL.

SHARON (CONTD.)
Hello, how can I help you?

CUSTOMER
Hi, I'd like three loaves of Italian bread, two plain, one seeded.

EL begins to pack up her belongings.

SHARON
(to CUSTOMER)
Coming right up, sir.
(to EL)
Despite her unforgivable sins in the eyes of Heaven almighty, she <u>was</u> a beautiful girl. I have to say, though—I really didn't like those piercings or the tattoos. Especially the one on her breasts. A woman's body should be cherished and unmarked. It sends the wrong message. Now, don't get me wrong, I'm a feminist. I even almost got arrested once at a protest at my campus. But I don't think it's right to scar God's work. Let his creations die as they were born. Shame, a God darn awful shame.

CUT TO:

INT. FEDEX KINKOS - AFTERNOON

EL is parked next to a printer in a Fedex Kinkos store. She edits some of the wording of the questionnaire she had created. Some hustle and bustle takes place around her.

EL looks up from her computer and off screen, giving an affirmative grin.

A FEDEX EMPLOYEE enters the frame shortly thereafter.

FEDEX EMPLOYEE
You ready to print?

EL nods, spinning her laptop around.

FEDEX EMPLOYEE
What size do you want these to be?

EL writes on pen and paper: “8.5in x 11in. Laminated, please. And I’d also like to print a 5 by 7 of this.”

CUT TO:

EXT. FEDEX KINKOS - AFTERNOON

EL exits the shop.

EL opens the package from Fedex. Checks the laminated cards.

CLOSE on a PHOTOGRAPH of SHEEN

EXT. STREET - AFTERNOON

EL walks down the street.

A buses passes by her, pulls up a bit ahead of her, MICAH and TEDDY get off at the stop.

EL caught up to them, but hangs back a bit—they do not notice her as she tails them and listens in on their conversation.

MICAH
You were wasted. Absolutely shitfaced hammered, man. So when I say it happened, it happened, and your opinion on the matter don’t really mean shit. I was the only sober-ish one. So trust a niggah when I say you missed some wild shit. Some life altering shit.

TEDDY
I wasn’t wasted wasted. I remember the whole night, practically.

MICAH
Do you remember Alfie and Mary hooking up practically on top of your dead body?

TEDDY
No.

MICAH
Or Antonio and Sara getting along, no fights, no beers flung across the room?

TEDDY
Yeah.

MICAH
That shit didn't happen. How'd you get so fucked? Did you drink the pussy punch?

TEDDY
I don't remember.

MICAH
Of course you did. Niggah, you don't go to a frat party and drink the goddamn punch. That is the unspoken code between brothers that the drinks are for the sisters to knock their asses out. And you, silly bitch, got your bitch ass knocked out.

CUT TO:

INT. UNKNOWN KITCHEN - NIGHT

A group of young men hover around a bubbling CAULDRON boiling and smoking. One of the men st[illegible] the cauldron.

A hooded figure emerges from the shadows with a vial. CLOSE on the text of the vial: "fuck bitches".

The hooded figure pours the vial into the cauldron.

All the men laugh.

CUT TO:

INT. COLLEGE KID'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

A line of MEN walk down a hallway into different bedrooms, each of the MEN have a passed out GIRL slumped over their shoulders.

CUT TO:

EXT. APARTMENT COMPLEX - AFTERNOON

EL and the boys turn into their apartment complex. They turn one way, she turns another and then hustles home.

SHEEN's door is open, there's a trash container in the courtyard, and DAVE throws trash from the second floor right down into the trash container.

EL hurries up the stairs and towards SHEEN's apartment. DAVE throws down another bag of trash and spots EL.

DAVE
Hey, honey. How was school? I got something for you. Wait here.

DAVE goes back into SHEEN's apartment. EL overlooks the balcony and sees right down into the trash container. She notices a bunch of SHEEN's paintings have been tossed away.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT - AFTERNOON

DAVE manically rushes around SHEEN's apartment with rubber gloves on his hands, a spray bottle of cleaner in one hand, and a scrub brush in the other.

DAVE enters SHEEN's art room.

DAVE
Wom[illegible] aren't talented.

CUT TO:

EXT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT - AFTERNOON

DAVE comes back outside with a black bag.

DAVE
Here you go. These are for the dog. They were the ones that hadn't been torn to shreds yet.

EL takes the black bag, pulls out her cellphone, and texts DAVE: "You can't throw away all this artwork. It just isn't right."

DAVE pats his pockets to find his phone, realizes he doesn't have it, then walks inside to SHEEN's apartment once more. EL follows behind him closely.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT / LIVING ROOM - AFTERNOON

DAVE (CONTD.)
Goddammit, where is my phone? This place is a disaster.

DAVE finds his phone.

DAVE (CONTD.)
Honey, what else am I supposed to do with it? Give it to a museum?

Museums usually ask artists for their art, not the other way around.

EL texts: “This is her life’s work.”

DAVE (CONTD.)
Yeah, I’m sure it is. That’s why everything is so cheap in here. But she won’t be the only person whose life’s work will be forgotten, honey. All of the things we do one day no one will care about. Believe me you, or is it believe you me? Either way, I’m pretty much already forgotten. You think anyone gives a rat’s ass that I put in windows? And window’s are my life’s work. Now I clean out someone else’s.

EL rushes past DAVE.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN’S APARTMENT / WORKSPACE - AFTERNOON

CLOSE ON one of the bigger pieces of art yet to be thrown away.

EL enters the frame, grabs it with both of her hands and leaves the frame.

CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN’S APARTMENT / LIVING ROOM - AFTERNOON

DAVE stands in the same spot EL left him, confused.

EL re-enters the room, art in hand, and walks right past DAVE and out of the apartment. DAVE calls out to her after she is gone:

DAVE
That’s going in your room, right?

CUT TO:

INT. EL’S APARTMENT - AFTERNOON

ALBIE lies by the front door. He hears DAVE’s voice shouting to EL, and his head pops up.

ALBIE hops to all fours when he hears the jingle of keys and the fussing with the front door as it opens, revealing EL, in her arms a giant painting and a black bag of dog toys.

EL places all that is in her arms down, letting the bag drop to the floor and then slowly places the artwork onto the ground.

EL dumps the dog toys onto the ground from the black plastic bag.

ALBIE becomes hysterical at the sight of his toys.

After settling her backpack down, EL leashes ALBIE.

EL and ALBIE take a brief moment to pause in front of SHEEN's painting.

CUT TO:

EXT. EL'S APARTMENT - AFTERNOON

EL and ALBIE hurry out from EL's apartment, EL locks the door behind her.

EL rushes to the banister over looking the courtyard below.

JEANNIE, in her scrubs, sashays through the courtyard, her cellphone in hand, head turned down, distracted, and in no rush.

CUT TO:

EXT. APARTMENT COMPLEX / HALLWAY - AFTERNOON

EL runs down the hallway, ALBIE just in front of her.

She keeps peeking down to the courtyard below, checking on the status of JEANNIE.

CUT TO:

EXT. APARTMENT COMPLEX / COURTYARD - AFTERNOON

CAMERA sees just over JEANNIE's shoulder, tracking her wandering and meandering pace. In the same frame's FOREGROUND, we can see the blur of EL and ALBIE come into focus. At first, EL and ALBIE darts towards JEANNIE. But just short of reaching her, EL slows down to a normal pace.

CUT TO:

EXT. JEANNIE'S APARTMENT - AFTERNOON

CAMERA sees a stretch of courtyard from their flank, EL and ALBIE enter the frame from the left hand side, JEANNIE, enters the frame from the right hand side—they're walking dead on towards each other. Stopping directly in front of JEANNIE's front door.

EL sends ALBIE over to get JEANNIE's attention. ALBIE approaches JEANNIE, and once the dog enters her periphery, she shrieks.

JEANNIE
Oh god, control your dog for christ's sakes.

JEANNIE looks up from her phone and realizes EL.

JEANNIE (CONTD.)
Oh, hi, El. You snuck right up on me. How are you, sweetie?

EL gestures 'so so.'

JEANNIE (CONTD.)
How'd you end up with her mutt?

EL doesn't respond.

JEANNIE (CONTD.)
Well, nice catching up with you. Tell your mother I said "hello."

JEANNIE makes to circumnavigate the EL and ALBIE blockage. JEANNIE moves around them and makes her way to her front door.

EL reaches into a pocket, pulls out a laminated questionnaire, taps onto JEANNIE's shoulder, and hands her the card.

CUT TO:

INT. JEANNIE'S APARTMENT / KITCHEN - AFTERNOON

EL, JEANNIE, and WALTER sit around their kitchen table. WALTER is JEANNIE's second husband, and he is also much younger than JEANNIE.

CLOSE ON WALTER

FLASH CUT TO:

INT. SHEEN'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

CLOSE on POLAROID on SHEEN's fridge, WALTER's face in one of the photos.

FLASH CUT TO:

INT. HIGHRISE APARTMENT - UNKNOWN

JEANNIE, dressed in a trench coat, paces back and forth across a smoky Manhattan apartment. Light slips in through the slots of the drawn down window blinds.

WALTER bursts in through the door, suitcases in hand.

They embrace and sloppily kiss.

JEANNIE
You're okay. You made sure from the right angle, right? You didn't shoot him in the back of the goddamn head like some child?

WALTER
Gun in the mouth, like we practiced. I got the drugs.

JEANNIE
Now we can run away together.

FLASH CUT TO:

INT. JEANNIE'S APARTMENT / KITCHEN - AFTERNOON

ALBIE sniffs WALTER's feet from under the table.

JEANNIE packs a pack of cigarettes.

WALTER
I don't know why you do that. It doesn't do anything.

JEANNIE stops packing the pack of cigarettes. Unravels the rapper and takes one cigarette out.

JEANNIE
It condenses the tobacco, moron. You're more on then—

WALTER
—off, I know. Also, really doesn't make any sense.

JEANNIE
Get the fuck outta the kitchen.

WALTER grabs a cigarette from JEANNIE's open pack, now discarded on the table.

He exits the frame.

JEANNIE (CONT'D)
They say that woman are naturally more mature than men are, and they, whoever 'they' are, are most definitely right. Therefore, it makes sense to date younger if you're a woman. Sweetie, date younger, never date no 25 years younger, let me be testament to that. I'm raising a second son. The only good thing: he's no shlep in the bedroom. Anyway. Let me see that card. Where did I put it?

EL does not react until the final question. She gestures towards the pile of mail on the kitchen table.

JEANNIE
I'd rather a little girl not have my cellphone number, so sorry. And yeah, you can't record this either.

EL writes on paper: "it is just for the interview."

JEANNIE
This is not an interview, sweetie. I just wanna let you know what I think of that little skank. Everyone should know the level of slut we have living in this apartment complex. You ever see how she leaves the house all dolled up, bare stomach, her ass cheeks hanging out of her shorts, mile high fuck-me pumps. Turning every guy's head. Sickening.

EL writes on paper: "she died last night."

JEANNIE reads the note, she lights another cigarette.

JEANNIE
Can't say I'm surprised. Let me tell you something, and let me tell you, 'this something' is not a something I go yapping my mouth about everywhere—I know someone on the path of destruction. Boy, do I know it well. When were you born, sweetie?

EL writes on paper: “2003.”

JEANNIE stands up and makes herself a martini, then sits back down.

JEANNIE

Oh, my god. I can’t believe there are people too young for this to even have taken place in their lifetime. 9/11? Twin towers? Well, a bunch of Paoki fucks crashed our own planes into a set of twin skyscrapers in New York City. I used to work in a show store on the third floor of one of the buildings. Our family would always set our clocks ahead so we thought we were already late and we’d rush and still be late. So I missed the ferry that mooring, and I watched those planes take down these buildings. My husband, not that little shit Walter, my husband, dear Jeffrey, was a fireman, he started work the night before, and then worked three days straight after. Poor guy was sick. And yeah, both of us knew a lot of people who died that day, and even both of us survived that day, Jeff didn’t really. He was never the same again. Physically and you know—

(she points to her head)

—or in here.

JEANNIE finishes the last gulp of her martini, stands to make another, then sits back down.

JEANNIE

I knew he was dead for a long time. I thought I did anyway. Until I heard the sound of Jeff blowing his head off.

(long pause)

Well, none of your horror movies do that image justice.

JEANNIE finished another last gulp of her martini, stands, and moves towards the counter, before turning to EL and says:

JEANNIE

El, Sheen was just another person circling the drain. Don’t worry

about saving people from falling
off the edge or you'll slip too.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / EL'S BEDROOM - EVENING

CLOSE on EL's LAPTOP SCREEN: she checks her email, and has received responses from all of the COLLEGE KIDS next door. They are free tonight at 10pm.

EL reaches down below her desk to pet ALBIE.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / HALLWAY - NIGHT

EL places her ear to DAVE and SANDRA's bedroom. The TELEVISION BLASTS.

CUT TO:

EXT. EL'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

EL closes and locks the front door behind her and ALBIE.

CUT TO:

INT. COLLEGE KID'S APARTMENT / LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

TEDDY, SUE, NICOLE, OMAR, MICAH, and EL sit on a Frankenstein couch in a circle around a coffee table, each of them with their laptops open on their laps.

Each one of them cycles through a pdf of the cropped out faces from SHEEN's polaroids.

NICOLE
Ugh. This one here—

CLOSE on GARY's CROPPED FACE.

NICOLE (CONT'D)
Total fucking creep. I moved in before Fall semester my freshman year. I still wasn't 18 until December. So I'm moving my shit in, and Gary comes out of nowhere and offers to help out, not without first staring me up and down. After some weird flirty comments, I tell him I'm 17, he

puts his hand on my lower back, he whispers into my ear, “And?”

SUE
Fucking creeper.

NICOLE
He’s 48, too.

SUE
What’s a 48 year old hanging out with 20 year olds for? Disgusting.

TEDDY
If I was almost 50, and still able to get 20 year old pussy, don’t confuse nothing here, I’d be getting it.

OMAR
Yeah, it’s not like as you get older that older people get hotter or something.

MICAH
Old tits will always be old tits.

SUE
And your old ass balls should be lucky to have a seat next to a pair old ass tits.

NICOLE
Pigs.

TEDDY
Oink. Oink.

OMAR
Bacon?

MICAH
We ain’t the police.

OMAR
Yo, Susan, what about this guy? He’s been in here before.

SUE
What page?

TEDDY
Seventeen.

SUE
Yeah, Sal. He delivers us our medicine. He's also in a few of these pictures you sent us.

FLASH on CLOSE UPS of MULTIPLE SHOTS of SAL's FACE.

EL types into the Facebook chat they have set up: "medicine? Do you mean drugs?"

MICAH
What's the difference?

TEDDY
One has lobbyists.

NICOLE
Okay, Karl Marx.

SUE
(to EL)
He sells us weed. He's cheap, he comes to us. Pretty good deal.

EL types into the Facebook chat they have set up: "does he come here a lot?"

SUE
We only call him whenever we run out. Forgot that he knew Sheen.

MICAH
You know when he's a fucking mile away his car is so loud. He's here all the goddamned time.

EL types into the Facebook chat they have set up: "what does he drive?"

MICAH
Yellow corvette with a modified exhaust.

OMAR
So fucking annoying.

TEDDY
It's so fucking sexy.

EL types into the Facebook chat they have set up: "does he sell other things?"

SUE
Not sure. Never asked him.

OMAR
I asked him for Adderal once, and he obliged.

MICAH
Those weren't Adderal, bro. We crushed those bitches up and sniffed them and that shit was Ritalin.

TEDDY
Yeah, remember Omar got super racist. We were all smokin cigs and these black kids were just down the way. Micah was dying to try and fight them.

OMAR
Oh shit, yeah. What the fuck, bro.

MICAH
I don't remember that.

OMAR
Yeah, you need to chill with putting stuff up your nose.

NICOLE
Why are you asking?

EL types and sends a message to the group chat: "She was an apparent drug user of opiates".

SUE
We don't fuck with that shit. At least, I don't.

TEDDY
Nope.

OMAR
Nah.

MICAH
Yeah, me neither.

NICOLE
Absolutely not.

EL types and sends a message to the group chat: "Would it be possible that Sal sold opiates?"

NICOLE
Possibly. But I don't think we would know.

TEDDY
More often than not, if you're selling drugs you're not just selling one drug.

MICAH
Yeah, if you decide to take that path in life.

TEDDY
Like a face tattoo. Once you get to that place in your life, there's no going back.

SUE
Don't be stupid. People who smoke weed look down on dope heads and pill poppers.

OMAR
Fuck, in high school this white boy sniffed a bar off his desk in homeroom, turned green and vommited all over the floor— everyone called him Kermit after that.

EL types and sends a message to the group chat: "Can you send me Sal's cellphone number?"

CUT TO:

EXT. GARY'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

CLOSE on EL and ALBIE's backs, their bodies are framed by GARY's front door.

EL knocks on GARY's front door.

They wait for awhile, but there is no answer.

CUT TO:

EXT. MEXICAN WASTELAND - DAY

GARY, shirt tied around his bald head, falls to his knees and passes out in a Mexican desert.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / EL'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

From EL's window, she looks down to the parking lot, and takes note of GARY's truck's absence.

EL searches online the best way to pick a lock with household items.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / EL'S BEDROOM - MORNING

CLOSE on EL's CELLPHONE as the alarm turns on and blares.

EL's hand OFF SCREEN enters the frame, and shuts off the alarm. We can see that EL is already dressed and ready for school.

EL opens up a drawer in her bedroom, she memorializes the photo of her mother from the beginning of the film, but now next to the photo of her mother is the photo she printed of SHEEN.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / EL'S KITCHEN - MORNING

EL sits at the kitchen table, a bowl of cereal before her, her laptop just in front of the bowl of cereal. Her earbuds are plugged in and she is getting to work.

After taking a mouthful of cereal, EL searches social media platforms for a SHEEN presence.

EL finds that SHEEN has no social media, and creates her a blog.

EL posts one of SHEEN's works to her new blog.

EL switches tasks. She reviews the feedback she received from her Tumblr following.

Some of her followers were able to do reverse Google searches of the previously provided cropped polaroid faces and linked to their social media accounts.

Some of her followers found information regarding the different drug baggie patterns EL posted. They lead her in different directions: the dark web, local sex shop websites (here they sell baggies to local drug dealers masquerading as button baggies), a few news stories, and a website that tracks local dealer's baggies.

EL sorts through all of this information. She collects the new and useful information into her desktop folder.

EL checks SHEEN's Instagram; the first post has a nice amount of likes.

EL closes the window, now just her desktop shows, a note on her desktop reads: “Top Suspects: 1) Sal, 2) Walter, 3) Gary.”

EL stands up from the table, then heads to the kitchen sink with her now empty bowl of cereal, then rinses it.

DAVE enters the kitchen, the light from EL’s laptop catches his eye, as does the list of EL’s top suspects.

DAVE pauses there, contemplating how to approach the situation.

DAVE

El—

(he starts with exasperation, then takes a breather reconsidering his approach)

—Walter, he’s a shithead, but I don’t think he killed anyone, sweetie. Don’t think he can even if he tried. He’s just some money hungry young twit trying to grab Jeannie’s 9/11 insurance cash out. As for Gary, I’ve known him since he moved in. We’ve both helped each other plenty and he gives me work every now and then. Believe me, El—Gary, he’s a stand up guy.

EL hurries back to the table, and closes her laptop.

EL and ALBIE exit the kitchen.

CLOSE on DAVE standing in the kitchen, confused.

A moment later, DAVE’s phone pings—a message from EL reads: “then why hasn’t Gary been home since after Sheen’s death?”

DAVE

Sandra is going to be pissed.

CUT TO:

INT. DAVE’S CAR - MORNING

DAVE and EL drive along the road, DAVE in the driver’s seat, leaned back and right arm cocked and leaning against the passenger seat. EL’s in the passenger seat gazing out of the window.

CUT TO:

EXT. DAVE'S CAR - MORNING

CAMERA sits on the hood of DAVE's car. We drive along for a bit, music builds in the background.

The car pulls into a development with a guardhouse, and DAVE navigates the car into the GUEST LANE.

CUT TO:

INT. DAVE'S CAR - MORNING

MUSIC plays over the interaction between DAVE and the GUARD. EL watches intently.

DAVE hands the GUARD his identification.

The GUARD withdraws into his alcove…

…makes a phone call, has a short conversation…

…walks back to the car, hands DAVE his identification…

…motions to him which direction the house they are aiming to get to…

…and then opens the gate for DAVE and EL to pull through.

DAVE and EL wind along a road that circles a lake, they bob and weave until they reach their destination.

DAVE PARKS the CAR, he waits a moment before saying:

DAVE
Should I come in? I've always been curious to meet him.

As EL sorts through the COMMUNICATION CARDS in her pocket, trying to find the ones that will be most useful in this interaction and moving them to the top of the pile, she nods 'No' to DAVE's offer.

EL hands DAVE a card that reads: "I can handle it."

CUT TO:

EXT. MANSION - MORNING

LOW ANGLE CAMERA shooting up to EL's shape being completely over bared by a large double wooden door.

EL knocks on the door.

Some time passes without any answer.

She knocks again. And again, no answer.

The CAMERA shifts to a HIGHER ANGLE as EL begins to pound on the door repeatedly.

CUT TO:

INT. DAVE'S CAR - MORNING

DAVE watches the door to the mansion open, from his angle he can't quite see who is on the other side of the door. The owner of the home is obscured in shadows.

CUT TO:

INT. MANSION / FOYER - MORNING

The door to the house slams behind EL, the man who let her in slamming it closed.

CLOSE on EL, the shadow of the MAN, his bare torso all thats in frame, as the lights from outside get cut off as the door closes. EL is scared.

EL's eyes dart around, the house is completely silent and everything is in perfect order. No lights are on in the house, it is all natural lighting, shadows persevere everywhere.

JULIAN walks from behind EL to the forefront of EL, leading her into the darkened house. JULIAN is the owner of the APARTMENT COMPLEX where EL lives. He is a fit, EASTERN EUROPEAN, wearing loose boxers, his body glistens with sweat. His face is obscured up until this point.

JULIAN
You lied, little girl. I don't like liars. But I do like your balls. Balls are something I can appreciate.

EL starts to follow JULIAN, but he halts, his body looming over. The CAMERA tracks up and we can see JULIAN's face, he has a giant scar running across the top of his scalp.

JULIAN
Did I say to follow me? Not a very good listener American girls are not.

EL backs up.

JULIAN
You wait here.

JULIAN jogs up his flight of stairs.

EL continues to look around the place, when she hears the sounds of JULIAN returning she hurries back to the spot she was standing in when he left keeping up appearances.

CUT TO:

INT. MANSION / JULIAN'S BEDROOM - MORNING

JULIAN changes his clothing.

He switches on the television and shifts through channels on his television, they are different feeds of live security footage.

He sees DAVE's car parked outside, he switches the channel and sees EL in the foyer nosing around.

CUT TO:

INT. MANSION / FOYER - MORNING

JULIAN emerges from the shadows of the second floor balcony, now in a robe. He saunters down the stairs to rejoin EL.

JULIAN
In my country, a little girl who can't open her mouth like you would be worth a lot of money under one condition, you can still at least moan and moan loud. I bet you moan nice and good. If she could not moan or cry or scream or beg, she would've been drowned by her mother and thrown into a hole to be forgotten.

JULIAN slowly draws closer to her as he speaks.

JULIAN (CONTD')
Come, let me show you there's nothing to hide, little girl.

CUT TO:

INT. MANSION / SECURITY ROOM - MORNING

EL and JULIAN are in a completely blacked out room with no windows or natural lighting of any kind.

A PROJECTOR projects a grid of security footage onto an entire wall. The footage periodically shifts from one APARTMENT COMPLEX to the next (JULIAN owns a lot of property).

JULIAN controls the computer displaying the projections with a tablet. He switches between feeds.

JULIAN
I own many properties. Not just in Florida. Some nicer then others. Unfortunately yours falls into the 'others.'

EL taps JULIAN for his attention and hands him a USB DRIVE.

JULIAN
What dates did you want, Nancy Drew?

EL writes down the dates she is requesting access to.

JULIAN
This little drive is way too small for quite a big load. But maybe we can force it in.

JULIAN starts to laugh uncontrollably. JULIAN places his arm over EL's shoulders and starts to massage her and move his hands towards her breasts.

EL, at first frozen, bites JULIAN's hand and then runs out of the room.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S SCHOOL / LIBRARY - AFTERNOON

EL prints a load of photos regarding the evidence she collected, and the information she amassed from feedback from her online following. She keeps her head in the air as all the photos print, she knows she'd be in trouble if she got caught using school printers for this task.

CUT TO:

EXT. STREET - AFTERNOON

EL checks the notifications on SHEEN's blog. She has gained a few hundred followers.

EL posts another one of SHEEN's pieces to the blog.

CUT TO:

EXT. POLICE STATION - AFTERNOON

ESTABLISHING SHOT of a POLICE STATION.

EL enters frame from the right and then proceeds to enter the Police Station.

CUT TO:

EXT. POLICE STATION - LATER

EL storms out of the Police Station. She stomps her feet, flips around and flips off the entire building.

CUT TO:

EXT. STREET - AFTERNOON

EL walks down the street. She hears a ping from her pocket and takes out her cellphone.

The exchange below is a series of texts back and forth between each other. The conversation plays out as EL continues to walk.

SAL's voice is muffled as if heard through a helmet.

SAL (V.O.)
Yo, you little bitch will best keep your little bitch nose to yourself. Stop sticking it into other people's affairs. Especially when he ain't have nothing to do with you. Be a fucking preteen while you still have the chance. Or I'll show you how big girls get treated.

EL texts: "Where were you the night Sheen died?"

SAL (V.O.)
I have an alibi. One I don't need to give to you.

EL texts: "If you're innocent why does it matter?"

SAL (V.O.)
I was at those apartments a lot. Your friend had a vacuum for a nose. I was not there that day though.

EL texts: "Prove it."

A YELLOW CORVETTE PULLS UP with a SCREECH ALONGSIDE EL on the wrong side of the road.

CUT TO:

INT. YELLOW CORVETTE - AFTERNOON

CLOSE on a GLOVED HAND unlocks the glove compartment of the car and opens it.

The GLOVED HAND reaches in and pulls out a pistol.

The DISEMBODIED HAND is attached to SAL in his yellow leather outfit. He sits the pistol on his lap, reaches over to the passenger door and opens it with a shove.

CUT TO:

EXT. YELLOW CORVETTE - AFTERNOON

The passenger side door swings open. EL steps back.

SAL
Get in. Leave your backpack and your phone on the street there. No tricks.

SAL shows EL that he has a pistol pointed right at her.

CUT TO:

INT. YELLOW CORVETTE - AFTERNOON

SAL and EL sit across from one another in the car.

EL has her hands on both knees, she is still.

SAL
Keep nice and still, no sudden movements. Don't want this gun to accidentally go off. I've killed people before. My connect didn't get his refill until the next day, so I was out of your girl's favorite flavor, no reason for me to come over there. Your girl only called when she was trynna get high.

EL texts, bluffing: "Autopsy report says her death involved drugs. If you didn't have any to give her how'd she get them?"

SAL
Your girl sniffed 5 pills a day. You take away a feen's high, they'll find something.

EL
Do you think she was killed?

SAL
Don't know. Don't care. All I know that it wasn't me. Why would I kill the bitch that sucked my dick? Five dollars short and she'd swallow. Sometimes I'd pretend she was was short.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / KITCHEN - EVENING

SANDRA, DAVE, and EL eat dinner in silence. EL hurries through her dinner, dumps her plate in the sink, and exits the kitchen.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / BEDROOM - NIGHT

EL and ALBIE lie in bed. EL cuddles ALBIE.

EL opens SHEEN's blog account to find more followers to have come to her account as well as lots of likes on her posts.

EL posts another one of SHEEN's pieces to her blog.

EL receives a ping. It's an email from JULIAN, he sent a link to a file with the past weeks worth of parking lot footage.

EL rushes over to her desk, pulls up the footage and starts with the speed increased to see the last time GARY's car was parked outside.

EL finds the moment that GARY leaves and never returns. This time matches around the two days accounted for between her death and the police finding the body.

CUT TO:

EXT. GARY'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

CLOSE on FRONT DOOR enshrined in shadows.

EL and ALBIE enter the frame from the left.

ALBIE keeps look out as EL works the lock open.

CUT TO:

INT. GARY'S APARTMENT / LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

We watch as GARY's apartment door swings open from inside. The door almost slams against the wall before EL lunges forward and grabs the door before it makes a bang.

EL and ALBIE hurry into the apartment. EL shuts and locks the door behind them.

TWO CATS rush to the front door, meowing.

EL bends down to pet them while also petting ALBIE.

The TWO CATS guide EL to the closet, she opens the door, and then the TWO CATS lead her to the kitchen.

CUT TO:

INT. GARY'S APARTMENT / KITCHEN - NIGHT

EL pours food into their food bowls. EL gives them each a fresh bowl of water.

CUT TO:

INT. GARY'S APARTMENT / BATHROOM - NIGHT

EL cleans out the cat litter.

CUT TO:

INT. GARY'S APARTMENT / KITCHEN

EL dumps the waste in the trash.

EL walks over to the cats eating and lapping up water. EL spends time with the cats and gives them love.

CUT TO:

INT. GARY'S APARTMENT / BEDROOM - NIGHT

EL opens the bedside table drawers, first finds underwear, then finds an assortment of baggies, all with the same design.

EL opens her cellphone, and using references photos, identifies that one bag in SHEEN's apartment matches all of these bags in GARY's drawer.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / LIVING ROOM

EL, SANDRA, and DAVE sit around the living room, mirroring the arrangement from the beginning of the film.

CLOSE on EL's face.

DAVE
We know this has been tough on you.

SANDRA
Really and truly very tough. Seems the job has been keeping you occupied, right? Some extra pocket change, at least.

DAVE
To be honest, I don't think I've ever seen you happier.

SANDRA
We told you how we were proud of you, right? You were really able to pick up some of the slack around here.

DAVE
Really impressive, sweetie.

SANDRA
In just six months you were able to turn it all around. We offered you a suggestion, and you took charge. Bravo to you.

DAVE
That's not why we're sitting you down though.

SANDRA
No, unfortunately not.

DAVE
We <u>are</u> so, so proud of you though.

SANDRA
Really and truly. But listen, this whole obsession—

DAVE
—I wouldn't necessarily call it an obsession.

SANDRA
This whole…passion…of yours that you've embarked on, this mission is a nothing but a journey to fantasy land. It's proving to effect your school life.

DAVE
Why have you been cutting school? Mr. Preston says you've been leaving after lunch?

SANDRA
You know we're being as hard on you as we'd be on our own daughter.

DAVE
And we think of you like a daughter.

SANDRA
Of course. Of course, we do.

DAVE
But you need to understand, this new here behavior will not stand. You can't go hunting for answers to questions that don't need asking.

SANDRA
Questions a little girl like you should not even be musing about let alone asking around town about.

DAVE
It's unhealthy for you, and we're concerned. That's all we're saying: we're concerned.

SANDRA
And let me just go on record as saying this: while Sheen might've seemed cool to you El, she might've been more then what your young eyes could account for. I think its fair to call a spade a spade when the deck is dealt. Sheen—

DAVE
—Sheen…she killed herself. She took too many drugs and killed herself.

SANDRA
That's what drug addicts do. Without fail. Their lives are dead ends.

DAVE
Like this wild goose chase.

SANDRA
Exactly, this whole conspiracy you are wrangling up is just that: a conspiracy. It will lead you nowhere, sweetie. You're just a kid. So trust me.

DAVE
I used to think 9/11 was an inside job. Still doesn't all add up.

SANDRA
A psycho killed a school full of children in Massachusetts. And conspiracy theorists thought it was a government scandal in order to take away guns. The conspiracy theorists wouldn't allow the poor parents to grieve their kid's deaths.

DAVE
Your mom is saying—

SANDRA
I'm not her mom.

DAVE
Sandra is saying that it's time to grieve.

SANDRA
It's okay to grieve, honey. Take this all as a learning experience.

SANDRA sends shade to DAVE.

SANDRA (CONT'D)
Right, Dave? Maybe we don't send our child to a crackheads house next time? Look what you've done to this poor girl. First her mother, now this pathetic girl.

She will not have any strong
female role models in her life.

SANDRA stands up and leaves the living room.

Once SANDRA is gone, DAVE repositions himself and takes up more space.

DAVE
Your mom—Sandra…didn't mean to get so hysterical. She just cares about you so much. Do you understand that? I hope that you can see that. Here's the big picture, good news slash bad news, bad news first: we need you to give up on this whole Sheen thing, good news we'll let you keep Albie. We can tell how much serenity he's brought here for you. But you must swear to me…to us, no more inquiries, no more pestering the neighbors, no more leaving school early. This is not how we want you to be representing our family. And you are a part of our family know, whether you like it or not. And as this is my house —my apartment—our apartment, what we say goes. Let's also add to the record: we—I—love you and just want you to succeed and not sink down the drain.

CLOSE on EL smiling.

CUT TO:

INT. EL'S APARTMENT / BEDROOM

EL sits at her desk, her back to the camera. ALBIE lies on the floor under the desk.

EL checks SHEEN's blog, which now has close to ten thousand followers. One of the recent photos EL posted has gone viral.

EL sees that the viral post has made its way to the front page of the internet.

A ping fires off.

EL checks her email, SHEEN has received an offer from art contractor in Miami regarding putting up one of her paintings in Wynwood.

EL takes some time to absorb the information, and she smiles.

EL, with her voice, reads the email out loud,

EL

Dear Sheen…on behalf of the city of Miami and the district of Wynwood we'd like to invite you to be a part of our 2018 catalogue. As you may know this a very prestigious honor. These art walls receive nearly one hundred thousand people's of interest a year and will greatly add reverence and honor to your name. Please write back to us as soon as possible and let us know if you would interested in participating in this great tradition. Your fan, the city of Miami.

EL types back: "Though the offer is a dream come true—Unfortunately, I must decline. Thank you for the great and wonderful compliment just in the extension of the invitation."

CLOSE on EL's contented face.

FADE TO BLACK.